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TEST BOOKLET SERIES

**Test Code:
2201****TEST BOOKLET
GENERAL STUDIES
TEST – 1****A****Time Allowed : Two Hours****Maximum Marks : 200****INSTRUCTIONS**

1. IMMEDIATELY AFTER THE COMMENCEMENT OF THE EXAMINATION, YOU SHOULD CHECK THAT THIS TEST BOOKLET *DOES NOT* HAVE ANY UNPRINTED OR TORN OR MISSING PAGES OR ITEMS, ETC. IF SO, GET IT REPLACED BY A COMPLETE TEST BOOKLET.
2. ENCODE CLEARLY THE TEST BOOKLET SERIES CODE **A, B, C** OR **D** AS THE CASE MAY BE IN THE APPROPRIATE PLACE IN THE ANSWER SHEET.
3. You have to enter your Roll Number on the Test Booklet in the Box provided alongside this line. *DO NOT* write *anything else* on the Test Booklet.
4. This Test Booklet contains 100 items (questions). Each question is printed both in **Hindi** and **English**. Each item comprises four responses (answers). You will select the response which you want to mark on the Answer Sheet. In case you feel that there is more than one correct response, mark the response which you consider the best. In any case, choose **ONLY ONE** response for each item.
5. You have to mark all your responses **ONLY** on the separate Answer Sheet provided. See directions in the Answer sheet.
6. All items carry equal marks.
7. Before you proceed to mark in the Answer Sheet the response to various items in the Test Booklet, you have to fill in some particulars in the Answer Sheet as per instructions sent to you with your admission certificate.
8. After you have completed filling in all your responses on the Answer Sheet and examination has concluded, you should hand over to the Invigilator *only the Answer Sheet*. You are permitted to take away with you the Test Booklet.
9. Sheets for rough work are appended in the Test Booklet at the end.
10. **Penalty for wrong answers:**
THERE WILL BE PENALTY FOR WRONG ANSWERS MARKED BY A CANDIDATE IN THE OBJECTIVE TYPE QUESTION PAPERS.
 - (i) There are four alternatives for the answer to every question. For each question for which a wrong answer has been given by the candidate, **One-Third** of the marks assigned to that question will be deducted as penalty.
 - (ii) If a candidate gives more than one answer, it will be treated as a **wrong answer** even if one of the given answers happens to be correct and there will be same penalty as above to that question.
 - (iii) If a question is left blank, i.e., no answer is given by the candidate, there will be no **penalty** for that question.

https://t.me/upsc_success_time1**DO NOT OPEN THIS TEST BOOKLET UNTIL YOU ARE ASKED TO DO SO***Note:* Hindi version of the instructions is printed on the front cover of this Booklet.



1. Consider the following statements:

1. In India, total annual production of rice has continuously been more than wheat in the last 5 years.
2. Production of pulses has been greater than cotton in the last few years.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

2. Consider the following statements:

1. The Charter Act of 1833 was the final step towards centralisation in British India.
2. The Charter Act of 1853 was the last of the series of Charter Acts passed by the British Parliament between 1793 and 1853.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

3. With reference to the devices of direct democracy, consider the following statements:

1. Plebiscite is a procedure whereby proposed legislation is referred to the electorate for settlement by their direct votes.
2. Referendum is a method of obtaining the opinion of people on any issue of public importance.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

4. Consider the following questions:

1. Indian territory can be ceded to a foreign state only by amending the Constitution.
2. Settlement of a boundary dispute between India and another country also requires a constitutional amendment.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

5. Which of the following articles of Directive Principles of the State Policy reflect the ideology of Gandhian Principles:

1. Article 40
2. Article 43
3. Article 43B
4. Article 51

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 1, 2 and 3 only
(c) 1, 2 and 4 only (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

6. With reference to India signing the Strategic Partnership Agreement with International Energy Agency (IEA), consider the following statements:

1. India has now become a full fledged member of IEA.
2. India has become a partner in the Global Grid Programme for renewable energy.

which of the statements given above is/ are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

7. With reference to 'Elephant Corridors' in India, consider the following statements:

1. The power to declare an area as an elephant corridor lies with the state government.
2. Elephant corridors are devoid of any obstacles to movement such as railway lines, canals, national highways or state highways.
3. There are around 15 elephant corridors in India.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 3 only

8. Which of the following provisions of the Indian Constitution came into force on November 26, 1949, itself?

1. Citizenship
2. Elections
3. Directive Principles of State Policy
4. Temporary and transitional provisions
5. Short title
6. Provisional parliament



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Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1, 2, 3 and 5 only
(b) 1, 2, 4, 5 and 6 only
(c) 2, 3, 4, 5 and 6 only
(d) 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6
9. Which of the following statements best describe the concept of secularism in India?
- (a) The Indian concept of secularism requires the complete separation of religion and state.
(b) Indian secularism does not require a total banishment of religion from state affairs.
(c) In the Indian concept of Secularism religion is relegated entirely to the private sphere and has no place in public life whatsoever.
(d) In the Indian model, the State does not intervene in the affairs of religion till the time religion is working within the limits of the law.
10. Consider the following statements:
1. Till the passage of the Indian Independence Act, 1947, India was a dependency of the British Empire.
 2. India ceased to be a British dominion on January 26, 1950.
 3. Pakistan continued to be a British Dominion until 1956.
- Which of the statements given above are correct?
- (a) 1 and 3 only
(b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3
11. 'The Great Reset' was in the news recently, it is an initiative of which one of the following organisations?
- (a) World Economic Forum
(b) World Health Organisation
(c) International Monetary Fund
(d) United Nations Environment Programme

12. The "Global Investment Trends Monitor" report is released by?

- (a) International Monetary Fund
(b) World Economic Forum
(c) United Nations Commission on Trade and Development
(d) World Trade Organisation

13. With reference to Martial law, consider the following statements:

1. The concept of martial law has been borrowed in India from the English common law.
2. The expression 'martial law' has been defined in Article 34 of the Indian Constitution.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

14. With reference to, Comptroller and Auditor General of India, consider the following statements:

1. Dr. B.R. Ambedkar considered it to be the most important office under the Constitution of India.
2. He can be removed by the President on same grounds and in the same manner as a Judge of the Supreme Court.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

15. Consider the following difference between Federal system and Unitary system:

1. Federal system has written constitution while Unitary system has written or unwritten constitution.
2. Federal system has a rigid Constitution while Unitary system has a rigid or a flexible Constitution.
3. Federal system has a bicameral legislature while Unitary system has unicameral legislature.
4. Federal system has supremacy of constitution while Unitary system has no supremacy of constitution.



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Which of the statements given above are **NOT** correct?

- (a) 1 and 3 only (b) 2 and 4 only
(c) 2, 3 and 4 only (d) 3 and 4 only

16. The term Multiparty Interim Arbitration (MPIA), seen in news is related to:

- (a) Alternate arbitration mechanism for WTO members
(b) Dispute settlement framework of the Supreme Court
(c) Insolvency resolution provision
(d) None of the above

17. With reference to Asian Waterbird Census, consider the following statements:

1. The AWC is conducted by the Bombay Natural History Society and Wetland International.
2. The census covers the entire East Asian - Australasian Flyway and a large part of the Central Asian Flyway.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

18. Which of the following statements is **NOT** correct?

- (a) The scope of judicial review power of the Supreme Court in India is narrower than that of what exists in the US.
(b) The parliamentary system is based on the principle of cooperation and coordination between the legislative and executive organs.
(c) The Indian Constitution establishes a judicial system that is integrated as well as independent.
(d) The Constitution of India contains only the fundamental principles of governance.

19. With reference to the 'democratic socialism', consider the following statements:

1. Democratic socialism aims to end poverty, ignorance, disease and inequality of opportunity.
2. Democratic socialism holds faith in a 'mixed economy'.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

20. With reference to the 'Preamble of the Indian Constitution', consider the following statements:

1. The Preamble gives direction and purpose to the Constitution.
2. It is more akin to the American Declaration of Independence.
3. The Preamble is the part of the Constitution as laid out in the Kesavananda Bharati case.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 3 only (b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

21. The tradition of making handmade paper 'Monpa' belongs to:

- (a) Arunachal Pradesh (b) Karnataka
(c) Kerala (d) Nagaland

22. With reference to the Digital Payments Index (DPI), consider the following statements:

1. It has been released by the National Payments Corporation of India.
2. The base period for this Index is March 2017.
3. According to the DPI-2020, the number of digital payments in India doubled between March 2018 to March 2020.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 3 only
(c) 2 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

23. Consider the following statements:

1. The integration of princely states with the rest of India was purely an ad hoc arrangement.
2. The S.K. Dhar commission recommended the reorganisation of states based on linguistic factors.
3. The JVP Committee formally rejected language as the basis for the reorganisation of states.



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Which of the statements given above is/are **NOT** correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) 1 and 2 only (d) 1 and 3 only

24. The writ of mandamus can be issued against
(a) a private individual or body
(b) to enforce departmental instruction that does not possess statutory force
(c) when the duty is discretionary and not mandatory
(d) any public body, a corporation, an inferior court, a tribunal or government

25. Risa is a traditional garment of which of the following states?

- (a) Tripura (b) Meghalaya
(c) Nagaland (d) Assam

26. In which of the following case the Supreme Court ruled that Article 21 only provides protection against arbitrary executive action, not from arbitrary legislative action?

- (a) Maneka Gandhi Case (1978)
(b) Gopalan Case (1950)
(c) Keshavanand Bharati Case (1973)
(d) Mandal Case (1992)

27. Which of the following is/are the application(s) of Doppler Effect?

1. Weather Forecast
2. Detect Speed of Cars
3. Detect human through a wall

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 1 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1 and 3 only

28. With reference to National Population Register, consider the following statements:

1. The NPR is a register of Indian citizens only.
2. Its objective is to create a comprehensive identity database of every citizen of the country.
3. The first National Population Register was prepared in 2003.

Which of the statements given above are **NOT** correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

29. With reference to the International Organization of Securities Commissions (IOSCO), consider the following statements:

1. Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) is an ordinary member of IOSCO.
2. Its members include securities market regulators and stock exchanges.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

30. Consider the following statements :

1. Citizenship (Amendment) Act, 2015, has introduced a new scheme called Overseas Citizen of India (OCI) Cardholder.
2. Citizenship (Amendment) Act, 2019 provides that the central government can cancel the registration of OCIs if he has been sentenced to imprisonment for three years or more within eleven years of registration.

Which of the statements given above is/are **NOT** correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

31. Consider the following statements:

1. If approved by both the Houses of Parliament, the President's Rule continues for six months.
2. The 38th Amendment Act of 1975 had raised the period of six months to one year.
3. The 44th Amendment Act of 1978 again reduced the period to six months.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3



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32. The report 'World Economic Outlook' is published by:
- World Economic Forum
 - International Monetary Fund
 - World Trade Organization
 - United Nations
33. With reference to the First Past the Post System (FPTP), consider the following statements:
- The FPTP system is also known as the simple majority system.
 - It allows for a truly representative mandate.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- 1 only
 - 2 only
 - Both 1 and 2
 - Neither 1 nor 2
34. Which of the following statements is **NOT** correct about Fundamental rights?
- Fundamental Rights are not different from other rights available to the citizens.
 - These are so important that the Constitution itself ensures that they are not violated by the government.
 - In the Indian constitution, special provisions have been made for the protection of Fundamental Rights.
 - Fundamental Rights are specially protected rights.
35. With reference to the Co-operative Societies, consider the following statements:
- The 97th Constitutional Amendment Act of 2011 added a new Part IX-B in the Constitution.
 - Recently the Supreme Court has struck down the portions of Part IX-B of the Amendment concerning 'Multi-State Co-operative Societies (MSCS)'.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- 1 only
 - 2 only
 - Both 1 and 2
 - Neither 1 nor 2
36. Recently, a report titled 'The Inequality Virus' was published. It was released by:
- World Economic Forum
 - Oxfam International
 - Reporters Without Borders
 - Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development
37. Consider the following statements:
- Indian Independence Act of 1947 abolished the office of the secretary of state for India.
 - The Government of India Act of 1919 introduced, bicameralism and direct elections in the country.
 - Indian Councils Act of 1909 provided for the separate representation of presidency corporations, chambers of commerce, universities and zamindars.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- 1 only
 - 1 and 2 only
 - 1 and 3 only
 - 1, 2 and 3
38. Which of the following statements is/are correct about the Indian Constitution?
- The Indian Constitution accepts the necessity of modifications according to changing needs of society.
 - The Indian Constitution is the final word about everything.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- 1 only
 - 2 only
 - Both 1 and 2
 - Neither 1 nor 2
39. With reference to the Vanadium metal, consider the following statements:
- Vanadium is used in the steel industry as it imparts toughness and strength to steel.
 - India does not produce any Vanadium and relies completely on imports.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- 1 only
 - 2 only
 - Both 1 and 2
 - Neither 1 nor 2





40. Coalition Government means:

- A government whose head enjoys nominal powers
- A government formed by an alliance of two or more political parties
- A representative government of a nation with a federal structure
- A government limited by the terms of the Constitution

41. Which among the following is **NOT** a right under the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights?

- Right to work
- Right to social security and insurance
- Right to freedom of thought and expression
- Right to education

42. Consider the following statements:

- Digital Services Tax is levied only on non-resident digital service providers in India.
- 'Significant Economic Presence' concept is used to establish a business connection of the digital service provider for taxation purposes.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- 1 only
- 2 only
- Both 1 and 2
- Neither 1 nor 2

43. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

- Limited amending power of Parliament is one of the basic features of the Constitution.
- Parliament can expand its amending power so as to acquire for itself the right to repeal or abrogate the Constitution or to destroy its basic features.
- Separation of powers between the legislature, the executive and the judiciary is one of the basic structures of the Constitution.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- 1 only
- 1 and 2 only
- 1 and 3 only
- 1, 2, and 3

44. Who among the following gave the slogan 'One Caste, One Religion, One God for All'?

- Sree Narayana Guru
- Jyotibha Phule
- Gopal Ganesh Agarkar
- Swami Vivekananda

45. Regarding the Financial Emergency, consider the following statements:

- There is no maximum period prescribed for its operation.
- Repeated parliamentary approval is not required for its continuation.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- 1 only
- 2 only
- Both 1 and 2
- Neither 1 nor 2

46. Which of the following statements is/are **NOT** correct?

- Ashokan pillar was adopted as the symbol (seal) of the Constituent Assembly.
- H.V.R. Iyengar was the Secretary to the Constituent Assembly.
- S.N. Mukerjee was the chief draftsman of the constitution in the Constituent Assembly.
- Sir B.N. Rau was appointed as the constitutional advisor (Legal advisor) to the Constituent Assembly.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- 3 and 4 only
- 2 and 3 only
- 2 only
- 1 only

47. With reference to Pravasi Bhartiya Divas (PBD), consider the following statements:

- PBD convention is a biennial event.
- Pravasi Bharatiya Samman Award is also conferred to organisations established by a Person of Indian Origin which have worked for the welfare of Indian community.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- 1 only
- 2 only
- Both 1 and 2
- Neither 1 nor 2



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48. With respect to the forms of power-sharing arrangements, consider the following pairs:

Type of government Form of power-sharing

- | | |
|-------------------------------|---|
| 1. Federal Government – | Power can be shared among governments at different levels – a general government for the entire country and governments at the provincial or regional level |
| 2. Coalition Government – | Power may also be shared among different social groups such as the religious and linguistic groups |
| 3. Community Government – | Power-sharing arrangements can also be seen in the way political parties, pressure groups and movements control or influence those in power |
| 4. Parliamentary Government – | Power is shared among different organs of government, such as the legislature, executive and judiciary |

Which of the pairs is/are **NOT** correctly matched?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 4 only
- (c) 3 only
- (d) 2 and 3 only

49. With reference to Decentralisation in India, consider the following statements:

- 1. The basic idea behind decentralisation was that there are a large number of problems and issues which are best settled at the local level.
- 2. The formation of local government helps to inculcate a habit of democratic participation.
- 3. A major step towards decentralisation was taken in 1992. The Constitution was amended to make the third-tier of democracy more powerful and effective.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 3 only
- (b) 1 and 2 only
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

50. With reference to the Shram Shakti Portal, consider the following statements:

- 1. It has been launched by the Ministry of Labour and Employment.
- 2. It has been launched to collect data related to tribal migrant workers.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

51. “To protect and improve the natural environment including forests, lakes, rivers and wildlife and to have compassion for living creatures,” is a provision made in the

- (a) Directive Principles of State Policy
- (b) Fundamental Rights
- (c) Fundamental Duties
- (d) Preamble

52. Recently a weapon system ASMI was in the news. It is a:

- (a) Air-to-Surface Missile
- (b) Machine pistol gun
- (c) Anti Tank Missile
- (d) Diesel-Electric Submarine

53. Consider the following statements regarding Inter-State Council:

- 1. President can define the nature of duties to be performed by such a council and its organisation and procedure.
- 2. It was set up based on the recommendations of the Sarkaria Commission.
- 3. Prime Minister serves as the chairman of the council.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3



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54. Consider the following statements:

1. Indian Constitution itself declares that Directive Principles are fundamental in the governance of the country.
2. Indian Constitution is founded on the bedrock of the balance between the Fundamental Rights and the Directive Principles.
3. Indian constitution has classified Directive Principles into socialistic, Gandhian and liberal-intellectual.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 3 only (b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

55. With reference to the Kala Utsav Initiative, consider the following statements:

1. It has been started by the Ministry of Education.
2. The program is organized under the Samagra Shiksha Scheme.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

56. Consider the following passage:

"I shall strive for a constitution which will release India from all thralldom and patronage ... I shall work for an India in which the poorest shall feel that it is their country in whose making they have an effective voice; an India in which there shall be no high class and low class of people; an India in which all communities shall live in perfect harmony."

Who among the following has said the paragraph mentioned above:

- (a) M.N. Roy (b) Vallabhbhai Patel
(c) Mahatma Gandhi (d) Jawaharlal Nehru

57. With reference to the Constituent Assembly, consider the following statements:

1. The elections to the Constituent Assembly were held in 1945.
2. The drafting of the Constitution was done by an assembly of elected representatives called the Constituent Assembly.

3. The Assembly adopted the Constitution on 26 November 1949 but it came into effect on 26 January 1950.

4. The Assembly had all its members from the Indian National Congress.

Which statements given above is/are **NOT** correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 1 and 4 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 4 only

58. Consider the following statements regarding Ramjet and Scramjet engines:

1. A ramjet is a form of air-breathing jet engine that uses the vehicle's forward motion to compress incoming air for combustion.
2. Ramjets work most efficiently at hypersonic speeds.
3. The Scramjet engine uses oxygen from the atmospheric air as the oxidizer.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

59. According to the Fazl Ali Commission the factors that can be taken into account in any scheme of reorganisation of states are:

1. Preservation and strengthening of the unity and security of the country.
2. Linguistic and cultural homogeneity.
3. Financial, economic and administrative considerations.
4. Planning and promotion of the welfare of the people in each state as well as of the nation as a whole.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1, 3 and 4 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1, 2 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2, 3 and 4



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60. Consider the following statements:

1. The telecom spectrum auction in India is done by the Telecom Regulatory Authority of India.
2. The International Telecommunication Union (ITU), has released standards for the sixth generation (6G) wireless communication.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

61. The Supreme Court in SR Bommai case (1994) enlisted the situations where the exercise of power under Article 356 could be proper or improper. Which of the following situations amount to proper imposition of the President's rule in a state?

1. Hung assembly
2. Maladministration
3. Disregard of Constitutional directions given by the Central government
4. Stringent financial exigencies

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 and 3 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1, 3 and 4 only (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

62. With reference to the India Innovation Index 2020, consider the following statements:

1. Karnataka is the top performing major state in this index.
2. The Index is released by NITI Aayog.
3. Number of Internet subscribers is one of the indicators used in the Index.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 only (b) 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1 and 3 only

63. Regarding the functions of the constitution, consider the following statements:

1. The constitution is to provide a set of basic rules that allow for minimal coordination amongst members of society.

2. The constitution decides how the government will be constituted.
3. The constitution enables the government to fulfil the aspirations of a society and create conditions for a just society.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

64. With reference to the four-fold classification of the states of the Indian Union, consider the following statements:

1. Part-A states consisted of nine erstwhile princely states with legislatures.
2. Part-B states comprised nine erstwhile governor's provinces of British India.
3. Part-C states consisted of erstwhile chief commissioner's provinces of British India and some of the erstwhile princely states.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

65. Consider the following statements:

1. Natural Capital Accounting (NCA) is a tool to measure the available stock of renewable and non-renewable resources.
2. System of Environmental-Economic Accounting (SEEA) is the accepted international standard for environmental-economic accounting produced under the United Nations.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2



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66. Which of the following statements is/are correct about India's asymmetric federalism?

1. Indian federalism has been constitutionally asymmetric.
2. To meet the specific needs and requirements of some sub-units asymmetric federalism has been designed.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

67. Which of the following facts are correct about the Kanha Tiger Reserve?

1. Swamp Deer is known as the 'Jewel of Kanha'.
2. It's official mascot is a tiger.
3. It is located in Madhya Pradesh.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- (a) 3 only (b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 1, 2 and 3 (d) 2 and 3 only

68. Who among the following were **NOT** the members of the Drafting Committee of the Constitution?

1. Syed Mohammad Saadullah
2. N. Madhava Rau
3. T.T. Krishnamachari
4. G.V. Mavalankar
5. Jawaharlal Nehru

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1, 3 and 4 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 4 and 5 only (d) 1 only

69. With reference to the Domestic Systemically Important Banks (D-SIBs), consider the following statements:

1. Commercial Banks are characterized as D-SIBs by the Ministry of Finance.
2. There is an obligation on the government to support these banks in times of distress.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

70. Consider the following statements about North Eastern Council:

1. North Eastern Council is an executive body for social and economic development of the North Eastern region.
2. The Prime Minister is the ex-officio Chairperson of the Council.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

71. Which of the following statements is/are **NOT** correct regarding Gobind Ballabh Pant?

1. He became Premier of the United Province in 1937.
2. He established an organisation called the Prem Sabha.
3. He was in favour of a separate electorate for minorities.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 2 only (b) 3 only
(c) 1 and 2 only (d) 2 and 3 only

72. In which of the following situations the imposition of President's Rule in a state would be proper :

1. Maladministration in the state
2. Stringent financial exigencies of the state
3. Hung assembly

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 and 3 only
(b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 3 only
(d) 1 only

73. Consider the following statements:

1. Indian liberalism privileges the rights of the individuals over demands of social justice and community values.
2. Classical liberalism is always linked to social justice.
3. The liberal state focuses on individual rights and freedom.



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Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 3 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 2 only (d) 3 only

74. Consider the following statements:

1. Indian laws follow a uniform code in most civil matters.
2. In India “personal laws” are mentioned in the Concurrent List.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

75. Consider the following pairs:

Major Committees	Chairman
1. Union Constitution Committee	– B.R. Ambedkar
2. Rules of Procedure Committee	– Rajendra Prasad
3. Provincial Constitution Committee	– Sardar Patel

Which of the pairs given above is /are correctly matched?

- (a) 1 and 3 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 2 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

76. With reference to the Corporate Average Fuel Efficiency Regulations, consider the following statements :

1. These regulations are for auto manufacturers so as to push them to manufacture fuel efficient vehicles.
2. These regulations help in reducing dependence on oil and controlling pollution.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

77. With reference to the Finance Commission, consider the following statements:

1. It is a body set up under Article 275 of the Constitution.
2. Members of National Statistical Commission and NITI Aayog are ex-officio members of the commission.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

78. With reference to the Asian Houbara Bustard, consider the following statements:

1. It is a large non flying bird found in Pakistan.
2. It's IUCN status is the same as the Great Indian Bustard.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

79. Regarding the Parliamentary form of government, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. In this executive is responsible to the legislature for its policies and acts.
2. It is also known as ‘Westminster model of government’.
3. Russia, Brazil, USA and Sri Lanka have this kind of government.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- (a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

80. Which of the following statements regarding the different exercises conducted by the Indian Defense forces is/are correct?

1. The Sea Vigil exercise is focused on coastal security.
2. Exercise Kavach is a tri-service exercise conducted in Andaman and Nicobar.
3. Desert Knight II is the desert warfare component of India-US Yudh-Abhyas exercise.



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Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 only
(c) 1, 2 and 3 (d) 1 and 3 only

81. Which of the following Directive Principles of the State Policy reflect the ideology of socialism:

1. To promote equal justice and to provide free legal aid to the poor.
2. To secure a living wage, a decent standard of life and social and cultural opportunities for all workers.
3. To promote the educational and economic interests of SCs, STs, and other weaker sections of the society and to protect them from social injustice and exploitation.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

82. The 'Solidarity and Stability' Agreement, recently seen in news is related to:

- (a) African Union
(b) Association of Southeast Asian Nation
(c) Gulf Countries
(d) European Union

83. Consider the following statements:

1. Bhartiya Nirdeshak Dravya is the reference material for purity of gold and other metals only.
2. National Atomic Time-Scale is used for generating the Indian Standard Time.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

84. Consider the following statements:

1. The Delimitation Commission is appointed by the President of India.
2. The copies of the orders of the Delimitation Commission are laid before the House of the People and the State Legislative Assembly concerned, but no modifications are permissible.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

85. Which of the following rights and privileges are available to Indian Citizens only?

1. Right against discrimination on the grounds of religion, race, caste, sex or place of birth.
2. Right to equality of opportunity in matters of public employment.
3. Equality before the law or equal protection of the laws within the territory of India.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 and 3 only (b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

86. This particular leader of the national movement has written the biographies of Giuseppe Mazzini and Shivaji. He belonged to the extremist faction in Indian National Congress. He was also involved with the Hindu Mahasabha. He died during the protest against the Simon Commission. He was

- (a) Batukeshwar Dutt
(b) Lala Lajpat Rai
(c) Ram Prasad Bismil
(d) Bipin Chandra Pal

87. With reference to the provisions to safeguard and ensure the independent and impartial functioning of the Election Commission, consider the following statements:

1. The Election Commissioners are provided with security of tenure.
2. The Constitution has prescribed the qualifications for appointment to the office of the Election Commission.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2



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88. With reference to the right to protest, consider the following statements:

1. The right to protest is implicit in Article 19(1) (a), which guarantees the freedom of speech and expression.
2. It is integral to the right to protection of life and personal liberty enshrined in Article 21.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

89. Consider the following statements regarding the Indian Pangolin:

1. They are naturally found in tropical and subtropical regions all over the globe.
2. Pangolins are nocturnal, toothless and their diet consists of mainly ants and termites.
3. In the IUCN Red List, they are categorized as Critically Endangered.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1 and 2 only

90. With reference to the 'portfolio' system, consider the following statements:

1. Indian Councils Act of 1861 gave recognition to the 'portfolio' system.
2. The portfolio system was introduced by Lord Dalhousie in 1852.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

91. With reference to the State of the Climate Report 2020, consider the following statements:

1. This report is released by the Centre for Science and Environment.
2. According to the report 2020 is the warmest year to be recorded in India since 1901.
3. According to the report, Over 90 percent districts in India are hotspots of extreme climate events.

Which of the statements given above are **NOT** correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

92. With reference to the provisions of the Prevention of Cruelty to Animals Act, 1960, consider the following statements:

1. Animal Welfare Board of India (AWBI) has been established under this act.
2. Under the act 'animal' has been defined as any living creature other than a human being.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

93. With reference to World Food Price Index, consider the following statements:

1. It is released by the International Food Policy Research Institute.
2. The index tracks the monthly changes in the food prices at the international level.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

94. Regarding the S.R. Bommai case, consider the following statements:

1. In the S.R. Bommai case Supreme Court concluded that the power of the President to dismiss a State government is not absolute.
2. The verdict ruled that the floor of the Assembly is the only forum that should test the majority of the government of the day.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor



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95. Which of the following statements is correct regarding the Dzukou Valley?

1. It is located at the border of Nagaland and Manipur.
2. Lilium Chitrangdae flower is endemic to this valley.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

96. With reference to Non-Resident Indian and Overseas Citizen of India (OCI) Cardholder, Consider the following statements:

1. Non-Resident Indians receive all benefits as available to Indian citizens.
2. OCI Cardholders will require special permission to undertake research work in India.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

97. Lithium is important for the electric vehicle industries. Which of the following is/are advantages of using Lithium-ion batteries?

1. High Energy Density
2. Low Manufacturing Cost
3. Fast Charging

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 1 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1 and 3 only

98. With reference to the National Commission of the Backward Classes (NCBC), consider the following statements:

1. NCBC was set up in 1993.

2. One of the functions of NCBC is to inquire into complaints with respect to the deprivation of rights of socially and educationally backward classes.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

99. With reference to the Pitt's India Act of 1784, consider the following statements:

1. It established a system of double government.
2. The British Government was given supreme control over Company's affairs and its administration in India.
3. It created a new body called the Board of Control to manage political affairs.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

100. Consider the following statements about the National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority (NPPA):

1. It functions as an attached office of the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare.
2. NPPA has been entrusted with the task of enforcing the provisions of the Drugs (Prices Control) Order.
3. NPPA can also fix the price for non-scheduled drugs.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3



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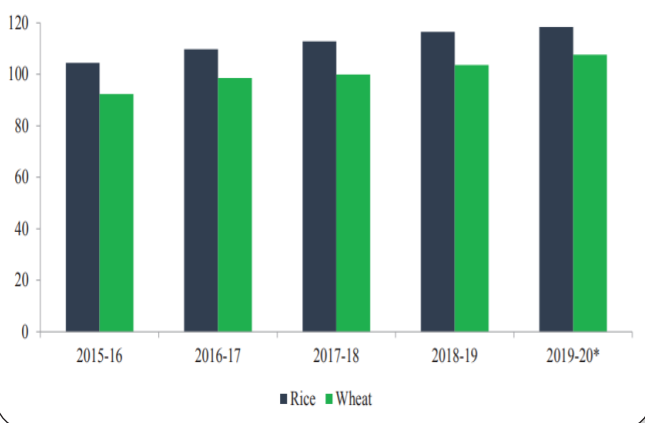
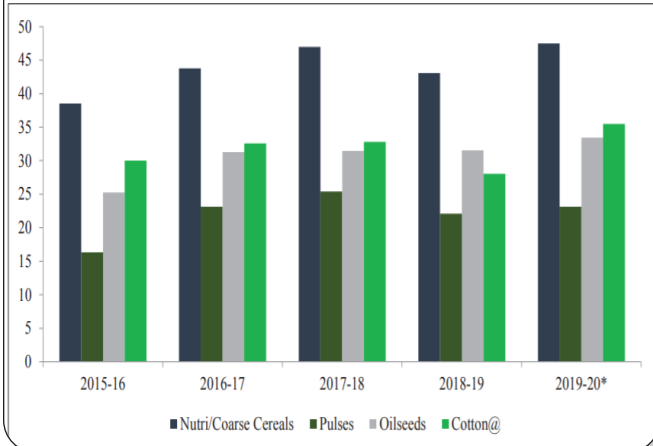
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ANSWER & EXPLANATION
GENERAL STUDIES
TEST – 01
A
ANSWERS

Q. No.	Answers	Q. No.	Answers	Q. No.	Answers	Q. No.	Answers
1	(a)	26	(b)	51	(c)	76	(c)
2	(c)	27	(a)	52	(b)	77	(d)
3	(d)	28	(d)	53	(d)	78	(d)
4	(a)	29	(c)	54	(b)	79	(b)
5	(b)	30	(b)	55	(c)	80	(a)
6	(d)	31	(b)	56	(c)	81	(a)
7	(a)	32	(b)	57	(b)	82	(c)
8	(b)	33	(a)	58	(b)	83	(b)
9	(b)	34	(a)	59	(d)	84	(c)
10	(d)	35	(a)	60	(a)	85	(b)
11	(a)	36	(b)	61	(a)	86	(b)
12	(c)	37	(d)	62	(a)	87	(d)
13	(a)	38	(a)	63	(d)	88	(b)
14	(c)	39	(a)	64	(c)	89	(c)
15	(d)	40	(b)	65	(c)	90	(a)
16	(a)	41	(c)	66	(c)	91	(d)
17	(c)	42	(c)	67	(b)	92	(c)
18	(d)	43	(c)	68	(c)	93	(b)
19	(c)	44	(a)	69	(d)	94	(c)
20	(d)	45	(c)	70	(d)	95	(c)
21	(a)	46	(d)	71	(b)	96	(c)
22	(b)	47	(c)	72	(c)	97	(b)
23	(b)	48	(d)	73	(d)	98	(c)
24	(d)	49	(d)	74	(c)	99	(d)
25	(a)	50	(b)	75	(b)	100	(b)

**1. (a)****Explanation:****Figure 4: Trend in Production of Rice and Wheat Crops (Quantity in Million Tonnes)****Hence, statement 1 is correct.****Figure 5: Trend in Production of Other Major Crops (Quantity in Million Tonnes)****Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.****2. (c)****Explanation:****Charter Act of 1833**

This Act was the final step towards centralisation in British India. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**

Features of the Act

- ❑ It made the Governor-General of Bengal the Governor-General of India and vested in him all civil and military powers.
- ❑ The act created, for the first time, a Government of India having authority over the entire territorial area possessed by the British in India.

- ❑ It deprived the governor of Bombay and Madras of their legislative powers. The Governor-General of India was given exclusive legislative powers for entire British India.
- ❑ The laws made under the previous acts were called Regulations while laws made under this act were called Acts.
- ❑ It ended the activities of the East India Company as a commercial body, which became a purely administrative body.
- ❑ The Charter Act of 1833 attempted to introduce a system of open competition for the selection of civil servants.

Charter Act of 1853

This was the last of the series of Charter Acts passed by the British Parliament between 1793 and 1853. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

Features of the Act

- ❑ It separated, for the first time, the legislative and executive functions of the Governor-General's council.
- ❑ It provided for the addition of six new members called legislative councillors to the council.
- ❑ It introduced an open competition system of selection and recruitment of civil servants.
- ❑ It extended the Company's rule and allowed it to retain the possession of Indian territories on trust for the British Crown. But, it did not specify any particular period, unlike the previous Charters.
- ❑ It introduced, for the first time, local representation in the Indian (Central) Legislative Council. Of the six new legislative members of the governor-general's council, four members were appointed by the provincial governments of Madras, Bombay, Bengal and Agra.

3. (d)**Explanation:****Devices of direct democracy:**

- ❑ Referendum is a procedure whereby a proposed legislation is referred to the electorate for settlement by their direct votes. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- ❑ Plebiscite is a method of obtaining the opinion of people on any issue of public importance. It is generally used to solve territorial disputes. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**



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- ❑ Initiative is a method by means of which the people can propose a bill to the legislature for enactment.
- ❑ Recall is a method by which the voters can remove a representative or an officer before the expiry of his term when he fails to discharge his duties properly.

4. (a)

Explanation:

- ❑ The power of Parliament to diminish the area of a state (under Article 3) does not cover the cession of Indian territory to a foreign country. Hence, Indian territory can be ceded to a foreign state only by amending the Constitution under Article 368. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- ❑ The Supreme Court in 1969 ruled that settlement of a boundary dispute between India and another country does not require a constitutional amendment. It can be done by executive action as it does not involve the cession of Indian territory to a foreign country. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**

5. (b)

Explanation:

Directives based on Gandhian Principles:

1. To organise village panchayats and endow them with necessary powers and authority to enable them to function as units of self-government (Article 40). **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
2. To promote cottage industries on an individual or co-operation basis in rural areas (Article 43). **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
3. To promote voluntary formation, autonomous functioning, democratic control and professional management of co-operative societies (Article 43B). **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**
4. To promote the educational and economic interests of SCs, STs, and other weaker sections of the society and to protect them from social injustice and exploitation (Article 46).
5. To prohibit the consumption of intoxicating drinks and drugs which are injurious to health (Article 47).
6. To prohibit the slaughter of cows, calves and other milch and draught cattle and to improve their breeds (Article 48).

Directives based on Liberal-Intellectual Principles

1. To secure for all citizens a uniform civil code throughout the country (Article 44).
 2. To provide early childhood care and education for all children until they complete the age of six years (Article 45).
 3. To organise agriculture and animal husbandry on modern and scientific lines (Article 48).
 4. To protect and improve the environment and to safeguard forests and wildlife (Article 48 A).
 5. To protect monuments, places and objects of artistic or historic interest which are declared to be of national importance (Article 49).
 6. To separate the judiciary from the executive in the public services of the State (Article 50).
 7. To promote international peace and security and maintain just and honourable relations between nations; to foster respect for international law and treaty obligations, and to encourage settlement of international disputes by arbitration (Article 51).
- Hence, option 4 is NOT correct.**

6. (d)

Explanation:

The Strategic Partnership agreement was signed between the International Energy Agency (IEA) and the Government of India on 27th January, 2021.

- ❑ It aims to Strengthen mutual trust and cooperation and enhance global energy security, stability and sustainability.
- ❑ This partnership will lead to an extensive exchange of knowledge and would eventually lead towards India becoming a full member of the IEA. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- ❑ The agreement includes a phased increase in benefits and responsibilities for India as an IEA Strategic partner. Building on the existing areas of work within the Association and the Clean Energy Transitions Programme (CETP), such as:

Energy Security

- Clean & Sustainable Energy
- Energy Efficiency
- Enhancing petroleum storage capacity in India
- Expansion of gas-based economy in India etc.



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- ❑ “One World One Sun One Grid” also known as the “Global Grid Programme” is a proposed initiative of the Ministry of New and Renewable Energy of the Government of India to develop infrastructure projects including railway networks, power grids in Africa, Europe and Asia. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**

7. (a)

Explanation:

- ❑ The power to declare an area as a Elephant Corridor lies with the concerned State government. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- ❑ There are about 100 elephant corridors in India of which almost 70% are used regularly. 75% of the corridors are in the southern, central and north-eastern forests. **Hence, statement 3 is NOT correct.**
- ❑ **Challenges for Elephant Corridors:** A study published by the **Wildlife Trust of India (WTI)** identified and recorded details pertaining to 101 elephant corridors across India. Some of them are given below
 - **Narrowing Passage Width:** Only 22% corridors are of a width of one to three kilometres in 2017, compared with 41% in 2005, pointing to how constricted corridors have become in the past 12 years.
 - **Human Encroachment of Corridors:** 21.8% of corridors were free of human settlements in 2017 compared with 22.8% in 2005.
 - **Intercepted Corridors:** About 36.4% of the elephant corridors in northwestern India, 32% in central India, 35.7% in northern West Bengal and 13% of the elephant corridors in northeastern India have a **railway line** passing through them. Almost two-thirds of the corridors have a **National or State Highway** passing through them, fragmenting habitats and hindering elephant movement further. 11% of corridors have canals passing through them. 12% are affected by mining and the extraction of boulders. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
 - **Land-use Along Corridors:** In terms of land use, only 12.9% of the corridors are totally under forest cover in 2017 compared with 24% in 2005. Two in every three elephant corridors in the country are now affected by agricultural activities.

8. (b)

Explanation:

Enforcement of the Constitution

- ❑ Some provisions of the Constitution pertaining to **citizenship, elections, provisional parliament, temporary and transitional provisions, and short title** contained in Articles 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 60, 324, 366, 367, 379, 380, 388, 391, 392 and 393 came into force on November 26, 1949, itself. **Hence option (b) is correct.**
- ❑ The remaining provisions (the major part) of the Constitution came into force on January 26, 1950.

9. (b)

Explanation:

Indian vs. Western Model of Secularism

- ❑ As per the western model of secularism, the “State” and the “religion” have their separate spheres and neither the state nor the religion shall intervene in each other’s affairs.
- ❑ Thus, the western concept of secularism requires the complete separation of religion and state.
- ❑ However, in India, neither in law nor in practice any ‘wall of separation’ between religion and the State exists.
- ❑ In India, both state and religion can, and often do, interact and intervene in each other’s affairs within the legally prescribed and judicially settled parameters.
- ❑ In other words, Indian secularism does not require a total banishment of religion from state affairs. **Hence, option (b) is correct.**
- ❑ As per the western model, the state cannot give any financial support to educational institutions run by religious communities.
- ❑ On the other hand, the Indian model has chosen a positive mode of engagement.
- ❑ In India, the state provides all religious minorities with the right to establish and maintain their educational institutions which may receive assistance from the state.
- ❑ In the western model, State does not intervene in the affairs of religion till the time religion is working within the limits of the law.
- ❑ On the other hand, in Indian secularism, the state shall interfere in religion to remove evils in it.



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- ❑ India has intervened by enforcing legislation against the practices of sati or widow-burning, dowry, animal and bird sacrifice, child marriage, and preventing Dalits from entering temples.
- ❑ In the western concept of secularism, religion is relegated entirely to the private sphere and has no place in public life whatsoever.
- ❑ The western model prohibits any public policy to be drafted based on religion, therefore; the state is distanced from the religious activities and practices of its citizens.
- ❑ In India, the state has the policy of setting up Departments of Religious Endowments, Wakf Boards, etc. It is also involved in appointing Trustees of these boards.

10. (d)

Explanation:

- ❑ Till the passage of the Indian Independence Act, 1947, India was a dependency (colony) of the British Empire. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- ❑ From August 15, 1947, to January 26, 1950, India's political status was that of dominion in the British Commonwealth of Nations.
- ❑ India ceased to be a British dominion on January 26, 1950, by declaring herself a sovereign republic. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- ❑ Pakistan continued to be a British Dominion until 1956. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**

11. (a)

Explanation:

- ❑ The World Economic Forum's (WEF) annual meeting in Davos (Switzerland) engages the world's top leaders to **shape global, regional and industry agendas**. The 2021 Davos Dialogue agenda marked the launch of the WEF's **Great Reset Initiative** in the post Covid world. **Hence, option (a) is correct.**
- ❑ **The Great Reset Initiative of WEF** is based on the assessment that the world economy is in deep trouble due to the **pandemic's devastating effects on global society, technological revolution, and the consequences of climate change.**

Agenda:

- ❑ The world must act jointly and swiftly to revamp all aspects of our societies and economies, from education to social contracts and working conditions. Every

country must participate, and every industry, from oil and gas to tech, must be transformed. In short there should be a **'Great Reset'** of capitalism.

Extra Info:

- ❑ The World Economic Forum (WEF) is a **Swiss nonprofit foundation established in 1971**, based in **Geneva, Switzerland**. It is committed to improving the state of the world by engaging business, political, academic, and other leaders of society to shape global, regional, and industry agendas. It was Founded by **Klaus Schwab**.

Some major reports published by WEF are:

- **Energy Transition Index.**
- **Global Competitiveness Report.**
- **Global IT Report** (WEF along with INSEAD, and Cornell University publishes this report)
- **Global Gender Gap Report.**
- **Global Risk Report.**
- **Global Travel and Tourism Report.**

12. (c)

Explanation:

- ❑ **The Global Investment Trends Monitor Report** is published by the **United Nations Conference on Trade and Development (UNCTAD)**. According to the recent report global **Foreign Direct Investment (FDI)** collapsed in 2020 by 42% to an estimated USD 859 billion from USD 1.5 trillion in 2019. **Hence, option (c) is correct.**

Trend in India and China:

- ❑ India witnessed a 13% year-on-year rise, the highest among key nations, in FDI inflows in 2020, China's rose by 4%.
- ❑ In absolute terms, China remained way ahead, with an inflow of as much as \$163 billion, while India's stood at \$57 billion.

Reason for the Rise in FDI in India:

- ❑ Inflows into the digital sector. The sector has particularly high return capabilities in India due to its favourable demographics, substantial mobile and internet penetration, massive consumption.

India's Measures to Increase FDI:

- ❑ Schemes like **Production-Linked Incentive (PLI)** scheme for electronics manufacturing have attracted foreign investments.



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- ❑ In 2019, the Central Government amended FDI Policy 2017, to permit 100% FDI under automatic route in coal mining activities.
- ❑ FDI in manufacturing was already under the 100% automatic route, however in 2019, the government clarified that investments in Indian entities engaged in contract manufacturing (contract manufacturing refers to the Production of goods by one firm, under the label or brand of another firm) are also permitted under the 100% automatic route.

13. (a)**Explanation:****Martial law**

- ❑ The concept of martial law has been borrowed in India from the English common law. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- ❑ The expression 'martial law' has not been defined anywhere in the Constitution. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- ❑ No specific or express provision in the Constitution authorises the executive to declare martial law.
- ❑ It is implicit in Article 34 under which martial law can be declared in any area within the territory of India.
- ❑ Martial law is imposed under extraordinary circumstances like war, invasion, insurrection, rebellion, riot or any violent resistance to the law.

14. (c)**Explanation:****Comptroller and Auditor General of India**

- ❑ The Constitution of India (Article 148) provides for an independent office of the Comptroller and Auditor General of India (CAG).
- ❑ He is the head of the Indian Audit and Accounts Department. He is the guardian of the public purse and controls the entire financial system of the country at both the levels—the Centre and the state.
- ❑ This is the reason why Dr. B.R. Ambedkar said that the CAG shall be the most important Officer under the Constitution of India. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**

Appointment And Term

- ❑ The CAG is appointed by the president of India by a warrant under his hand and seal.
- ❑ He holds office for a period of six years or upto the age of 65 years, whichever is earlier.

- ❑ He can resign any time from his office by addressing the resignation letter to the president.
- ❑ He can also be removed by the President on the same grounds and in the same manner as a judge of the Supreme Court. In other words, he can be removed by the president on the basis of a resolution passed to that effect by both the Houses of Parliament with special majority, either on the ground of proved misbehaviour or incapacity. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

15. (d)**Explanation:**

Federal Government	Unitary Government
1. Dual Government	1. single Government
2. Written Constitution	2. Constitution may be written or unwritten
3. Division of powers between the national and regional government	3. No division of power. All powers are vested in the national government
4. Supremacy of the Constitution	4. Constitution may be supreme (Japan) or may not be supreme (Britain)
5. Rigid Constitution	5. Constitution may be rigid or flexible
6. Independent Judiciary	6. Judiciary may be independent or may not be independent
7. Bicameral Legislation	7. Legislature may be Bicameral or Unicameral

Hence, option (d) is correct.

16. (a)**Explanation:**

- ❑ The WTO's Appellate Body (AB) is a permanent body setup under the Dispute Settlement Understanding (DSU) to resolve appeals on issues of law.
- ❑ It is ordinarily composed of seven members having a four-year term, with the possibility of one reappointment.
- ❑ Since July 2017, the United States has been stalling AB appointments creating the 'Appellate Body crisis'.



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- ❑ With fewer than three members to hear any appeal since 10th December, 2019, the AB is not able to function.
- ❑ Due to this around 23 WTO members have created a **Multiparty Interim Arbitration (MPIA) mechanism**. Hence, option (a) is correct.
- ❑ EU, China, Brazil, Australia, New Zealand are some of the key members of MPIA.
- ❑ India has not joined MPIA.

17. (c)**Explanation:**

The two-day Asian Waterbird Census-2020 has commenced in Andhra Pradesh under the aegis of experts from the Bombay Natural History Society (BNHS).

Scope:

- ❑ It was **initiated in 1987 in the Indian subcontinent** and has grown rapidly to **cover major regions of Asia**, from Afghanistan eastwards to Japan, Southeast Asia and Australasia.
- ❑ The census **covers the entire East Asian - Australasian Flyway** and a large part of the **Central Asian Flyway**. Hence, statement 2 is correct.
 - The **East Asia - Australasia Flyway** extends from Arctic Russia and North America to the southern limits of Australia and New Zealand. It encompasses large parts of East Asia, all of Southeast Asia and **includes eastern India and the Andaman and Nicobar Islands**.
 - The Central Asian Flyway (CAF) **covers a large continental area of Eurasia** between the Arctic and Indian Oceans and the associated island chains.

AWC in India:

- ❑ The AWC is **jointly coordinated by the Bombay Natural History Society (BNHS) and Wetlands International**. Hence, statement 1 is correct.
 - BNHS is a **pan-India wildlife research organization**, which has been promoting the cause of nature conservation since 1883.
 - A reference list of internationally important AWC sites and wetland IBAs in India has been prepared. India has 42 Ramsar sites, the latest one included is Tso Kar Wetland Complex of Ladakh.

- **BirdLife's Important Bird and Biodiversity Area (IBA) Programme** identifies, monitors and protects a global network of priority sites for the conservation of birds and other wildlife. India has **more than 450 sites**.
- The 13th Meeting of the **Conference of the Parties to the Convention on the Conservation of Migratory Species of Wild Animals (CMS COP13)** concluded in Gandhinagar, Gujarat in February 2020.
- Ten new species were added to CMS Appendices at COP13. Seven species were added to Appendix I (provides the strictest protection) including the **Asian Elephant, Jaguar, Great Indian Bustard, Bengal Florican**, etc.

18. (d)**Explanation:**

- ❑ The scope of judicial review power of the Supreme Court in India is narrower than that of what exists in the US. This is because the American Constitution provides for 'due process of law' against that of 'procedure established by law' contained in the Indian Constitution (Article 21). Hence, option (a) is correct.
- ❑ The parliamentary system is based on the principle of cooperation and coordination between the legislative and executive organs while the presidential system is based on the doctrine of separation of powers between the two organs.
- ❑ The Indian Constitution establishes a judicial system that is integrated as well as independent. The Supreme Court stands at the top of the integrated judicial system in the country. Below it, there are high courts at the state level. Under a high court, there is a hierarchy of subordinate courts, that is, district courts and other lower courts.
- ❑ The Constitution contains not only the fundamental principles of governance but also detailed administrative provisions. Further, those matters which in other modern democratic countries have been left to the ordinary legislation or established political conventions have also been included in the constitutional document itself in India. Hence, option (d) is NOT correct.

19. (c)**Explanation:**

- ❑ The Indian brand of socialism is a 'democratic socialism' and not a 'communistic socialism' (also known as 'state



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socialism') which involves the nationalisation of all means of production and distribution and the abolition of private property.

- ❑ Democratic socialism holds faith in a 'mixed economy' where both public and private sectors co-exist side by side. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- ❑ In G.B. Pant University of Agriculture and Technology v. State of Uttar Pradesh (2000) Supreme Court held that 'Democratic socialism aims to end poverty, ignorance, disease and inequality of opportunity. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**

20. (d)

Explanation:

- ❑ The Preamble, which is an identity card of the Constitution, is more akin to the American Declaration of Independence (July 4, 1776) than to the preamble to the Constitution of the United States, opined Justice Hidayatullah in the Sankari Prasad case [1952]. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- ❑ The Preamble gives direction and purpose to the Constitution which is reflected in the Fundamental Rights and Directive Principles of State Policy. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- ❑ The Preamble is the part of the Constitution as laid out in the Kesavananda Bharati case. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**

21. (a)

Explanation:

Monpa Handmade Paper

- ❑ Recently, the Monpa Handmade Paper (1000-year old heritage art) of Arunachal Pradesh has been revived by Khadi and Village Industries Commission (KVIC). **Hence, option (a) is correct.**
- ❑ The fine-textured handmade paper, which is called Mon Shugu in the local dialect, is integral to the vibrant culture of the local tribes in Tawang.
- ❑ The paper has great historic and religious significance as it is the paper used for writing Buddhist scriptures and hymns in monasteries.
- ❑ The Monpa handmade paper is made from the bark of a local tree called Shugu Sheng, which has medicinal values too.

22. (b)

Explanation:

Digital Payments Index

- ❑ The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has constructed a composite Digital Payments Index (DPI) to capture the extent of digitisation of payments across the country. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**

About the Index:

- ❑ The RBI-DPI comprises **5 broad parameters** that enable the **measurement of deepening and penetration of digital payments** in the country **over different time periods.**

5 Parameters:

- **Payment Enablers** (weight 25%),
- **Payment Infrastructure – Demand-side factors** (10%),
- **Payment Infrastructure – Supply-side factors** (15%),
- **Payment Performance** (45%) and
- **Consumer Centricity** (5%).
- ❑ It has been **constructed with March 2018 as the base period**, i.e. DPI score for March 2018 is set at 100. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- ❑ It will be **published on RBI's website on a semi-annual basis** from March 2021 onwards with a lag of 4 months.
- ❑ **Index Value for 2019 and 2020:**
 - The DPI for March 2019 and March 2020 worked out to be 153.47 and 207.84 respectively, indicating appreciable growth.
 - Penetration of digital payments in India doubled between March 2018 to March 2020. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**

23. (b)

Explanation:

- ❑ The integration of princely states with the rest of India has purely an ad hoc arrangement. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- ❑ In June 1948, the Government of India appointed the Linguistic Provinces Commission under the chairmanship of S K Dhar.



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- ❑ The S K Dhar commission submitted its report in December 1948 and recommended the reorganisation of states based on administrative convenience rather than a linguistic factor. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- ❑ The JVP committee was set up by Congress in December 1948. It consisted of Jawaharlal Nehru, Vallabhbhai Patel and Pattabhi Sitaramayya and hence, was popularly known as JVP Committee.
- ❑ The JVP Committee submitted its report in April 1949 and formally rejected language as the basis for the reorganisation of states. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**

24. (d)

Explanation:

Mandamus

- ❑ It is a command issued by the court to a public official asking him to perform the official duties that he has failed or refused to perform.
- ❑ It can also be issued against any public body, a corporation, an inferior court, a tribunal or government for the same purpose. **Hence, option (d) is correct.**

The writ of mandamus cannot be issued against

- (a) a private individual or body;
- (b) to enforce departmental instruction that does not possess statutory force;
- (c) when the duty is discretionary and not mandatory;
- (d) to enforce a contractual obligation;
- (e) against the president of India or the state governors; and
- (f) against the chief justice of a high court acting in a judicial capacity.

25. (a)

Explanation:

About Risa:

- ❑ Risa is a **handwoven cloth** used as a female upper garment. It is Tripura's signature garment. **Hence, option (a) is correct.**
- ❑ Risa is a **part of traditional Tripuri attire** that comprises three parts - **risa, rignai and rikutu.**
 - **Rignai:** It is primarily worn as the **lower garment** and literally translates into 'to wear'. It can be understood as an indigenous variety of the **sari** of mainland India.

- **Rituku:** It is mainly used as a wrap, or like a '**chunri**' or a '**pallu**' of the Indian saree.

- ❑ Sometimes, Risa is also used as **headgear, a stole, or a present** to express respect.

26. (b)

Explanation:

- ❑ Article 13 declares that a constitutional amendment is not a law and hence cannot be challenged. However, the Supreme Court held in the **Kesavananda Bharati case (1973)** that a Constitutional amendment can be challenged on the ground that it violates a fundamental right that forms a part of the 'basic structure' of the Constitution and hence, can be declared as void.
- ❑ In the famous **Mandal case (1992)**, the scope and extent of Article 16(4), which provides for reservation of jobs in favour of backward classes, has been examined thoroughly by the Supreme Court. It upheld the constitutional validity of 27% reservation for the OBCs with certain conditions.
- ❑ In the famous **Gopalan case (1950)**, the Supreme Court has taken a narrow interpretation of the Article 21. It held that the protection under Article 21 is available only against arbitrary executive action and not from arbitrary legislative action. **Hence, option (b) is correct.**
- ❑ But, in **Menaka case (1978)**, the Supreme Court overruled its judgement in the **Gopalan case** by taking a wider interpretation of the **Article 21**. It ruled that the right to life and personal liberty of a person can be deprived by a law provided the procedure prescribed by that law is reasonable, fair and just.
- ❑ Further, the court held that the 'right to life' as embodied in **Article 21** is not merely confined to animal existence or survival but it includes within its ambit the right to live with human dignity and all those aspects of life which go to make a man's life meaningful, complete and worth living.

27. (a)

Explanation:

Radar (Radio Detection and Ranging):

- It is a device which **uses electromagnetic waves in the microwaves region** to detect location (range & direction), altitude, intensity and movement of moving and non-moving objects.



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❑ Doppler radar :

- It is a specialized radar that uses the **Doppler effect** to produce velocity data about objects at a distance

◆ Doppler effect:

- When the **source and the signal are in relative motion to each other there is a change in the frequency** observed by the observer. If they are **moving closer, frequency increases and vice versa.**
- When the waves bounce off a moving object their frequency is affected.
- It does this by **bouncing a microwave signal off a desired target and analyzing how the object's motion has altered the frequency of the returned signal.**
- This **variation gives direct and highly accurate measurements** of the radial component of a target's velocity relative to the radar.

❑ Application of Doppler Effect

- Doppler radars use this effect to predict short range **weather observation.**
- Used by police to **detect the speed of cars.**
- This effect is used in radars to **detect human movement through a door or wall.** The device can detect movement due to human respiration from up to three metres away.

Hence, 1, 2 and 3 are correct.

28. (d)

Explanation:

National Population Register

- ❑ The NPR is a register of usual residents of the country.
- ❑ Every usual resident of India must register in the NPR.
- ❑ It includes both Indian citizens as well as foreign citizens. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- ❑ The objective of the NPR is to create a comprehensive identity database of every usual resident in the country. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- ❑ The first National Population Register was prepared in 2010 and updating this data was done during 2015. **Hence, statement 3 is NOT correct.**

29. (c)

Explanation:

International Organization of Securities Commissions (IOSCO)

- ❑ The International Financial Services Centres Authority (IFSCA) has become an associate member of the

International Organization of Securities Commissions (IOSCO).

- ❑ Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) is an ordinary member of IOSCO. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**

International Organization of Securities Commissions (IOSCO)

- ❑ Date Founded: April 1983
- ❑ Headquarters: Madrid, Spain
- ❑ IOSCO Asia Pacific Hub is located in Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia.
- ❑ It is the international organization that brings together the world's securities regulators, covering more than 95% of the world's securities markets, and is the global standard-setter for the securities sector.
- ❑ It works closely with the G20 (Group of Twenty) and the Financial Stability Board (FSB) in setting up the standards for strengthening the securities markets.
- ❑ Current No. of Members: 229 (March 2021)
- ❑ There are three categories of members: ordinary, associate and affiliate.
 - In general, **the ordinary members (129)** are the national securities commissions or similar governmental bodies with significant authority over securities or derivatives markets in their respective jurisdictions.
 - **Associate members (33)** are usually supranational governmental regulators, subnational government regulators, intergovernmental international organizations and other international standard-setting bodies, as well as other governmental bodies with an appropriate interest in securities regulation.
 - **Affiliate members (67)** are **self-regulatory organizations, securities exchanges, financial market infrastructures, international bodies** other than governmental organizations with an appropriate interest in securities regulation, investor protection funds and compensation funds, and other bodies with an appropriate interest in securities regulation. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

30. (b)

Explanation:

Citizenship (Amendment) Act, 2015

- ❑ Citizenship (Amendment) Act, 2015, has modified the provisions about the OCI in the Principal Act.



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- ❑ It has introduced a new scheme called “Overseas Citizen of India Cardholder” by merging the PIO card scheme and the OCI card scheme. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**

Citizenship (Amendment) Act, 2019

The Act provides that the central government may cancel the registration of OCIs on certain grounds. These include:

- ❑ if the OCI has registered through fraud,
- ❑ if, within five years of registration, the OCI has been sentenced to imprisonment for two years or more. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- ❑ if it becomes necessary in the interest of sovereignty and security of India.
- ❑ The Bill adds one more ground for cancelling the registration, that is if the OCI has violated the provisions of the Act or any other law as notified by the central government.
- ❑ The orders for cancellation of OCI should not be passed till the OCI cardholder is allowed to be heard.

31. (b)

Explanation:

- ❑ Article 355 imposes a duty on the Centre to ensure that the government of every state is carried on in accordance with the provisions of the Constitution. It is this duty in the performance of which the Centre takes over the government of a state under Article 356 in case of failure of constitutional machinery in the state. This is popularly known as ‘President’s Rule’. It is also known as ‘State Emergency’ or ‘Constitutional Emergency’.
- ❑ If approved by both the Houses of Parliament, the President’s Rule continues for six months. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- ❑ The 42nd Amendment Act of 1976 had raised the period of six months to one year. Thus, once approved by both the Houses of Parliament, the proclamation of President’s Rule could continue for one year. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- ❑ The 44th Amendment Act of 1978 again reduced the period to six months. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**

32. (b)

Explanation:

- ❑ Recently, the latest **World Economic Outlook** of the **International Monetary Fund (IMF)** has estimated

that India’s **Gross Domestic Product (GDP)** will grow by **11.5%** in the **Financial Year (FY) 2021-22**. **Hence, option (b) is correct.**

Key Points

❑ India Specific Projections:

- **FY 2020-21:** For the current fiscal, the IMF had forecast a record **10.3% contraction**.
- **FY 2021-22:** For the next fiscal, starting from April 1st, GDP growth projection is at **11.5%**, 2.7% higher than the projection made in October, 2020.
 - ◆ Last October, the IMF had projected an 8.8% real GDP growth for India in **FY 2021-22**, highest globally.
- **FY 2022-23:** In FY 2022-23, the economy will likely grow **6.8%**.

33. (a)

Explanation:

- ❑ The first-past-the-post (FPTP) system is also known as the simple majority system. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- ❑ In this voting method, the candidate with the highest number of votes in a constituency is declared the winner.
- ❑ This system is used in India in the direct elections to the Lok Sabha and State Legislative Assemblies.
- ❑ While FPTP is relatively simple, it does not always allow for a truly representative mandate, as the candidate could win despite securing less than half the votes in a contest. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- ❑ Smaller parties representing specific groups have a lower chance of being elected in the First Past the Post system.

34. (a)

Explanation:

- ❑ Fundamental Rights are so important that the Constitution itself ensures that they are not violated by the government.
- ❑ Fundamental Rights are different from other rights available to the citizens. **Hence, option (a) is correct.**
- ❑ The word fundamental suggests that these rights are so important that the Constitution has separately listed them and made special provisions for their protection.
- ❑ These rights are protected and guaranteed by the constitution of the country.



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**35. (a)****Explanation:**

- ❑ The 97th Constitutional Amendment Act of 2011 added a new Part IX-B in the Constitution which is entitled “The Cooperative Societies” (Articles 243-ZH to 243-ZT). Hence, statement 1 is correct.
- ❑ Recently, the Supreme Court (SC) upheld a 2013 judgment of the Gujarat High Court and struck down certain provisions of the Constitution (97th Amendment) Act, 2011.

Supreme court Upheld the Validity of**Provisions related to Multi-State Cooperative Societies:**

- It did not strike down the portions of Part IXB of the Amendment concerning ‘Multi-State Co-operative Societies (MSCS)’ due to the lack of ratification. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- When it comes to MSCS with objects not confined to one State, the legislative power would be that of the Union of India which is contained in Entry 44 List I (Union List).
- It is declared that Part IXB of the Constitution is operative only insofar as it concerns multi-State cooperative societies both within the various States and in the Union Territories.

36. (b)**Explanation:****The Inequality Virus Report: Oxfam International**

- ❑ Recently, the **Inequality Virus Report**, released by Oxfam International, has found that the Covid pandemic deeply increased the existing inequalities in India and around the world. **Hence, option (b) is correct.**
- ❑ The report states that Covid has the potential to increase economic inequality in almost every country at once - the first time this has happened since records began over a century ago.

37. (d)**Explanation:****Important features of the Indian Independence Act of 1947**

- ❑ It ended the British rule in India and declared India as an independent and sovereign state from August 15, 1947.

- ❑ It provided for the partition of India and the creation of two independent dominions of India and Pakistan with the right to secede from the British Commonwealth.
- ❑ It abolished the office of the viceroy and provided, for each dominion, a governor-general, who was to be appointed by the British King on the advice of the Dominion cabinet. His Majesty’s Government in Britain was to have no responsibility with respect to the Government of India or Pakistan.
- ❑ It abolished the office of the secretary of state for India and transferred his functions to the secretary of state for Commonwealth Affairs. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**

Important features of The Government of India Act of 1919

- ❑ It introduced, for the first time, bicameralism and direct elections in the country. Thus, the Indian Legislative Council was replaced by a bicameral legislature consisting of an Upper House (Council of State) and a Lower House (Legislative Assembly). **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- ❑ The majority of members of both the Houses were chosen by direct election.
- ❑ It relaxed the central control over the provinces by demarcating and separating the central and provincial subjects.
- ❑ It further divided the provincial subjects into two parts—transferred and reserved.
- ❑ It required that the three of the six members of the Viceroy’s Executive Council (other than the commander-in-chief) were to be Indian.

Important features of the Indian Councils Act of 1909

- ❑ It considerably increased the size of the legislative councils, both Central and provincial. The number of members in the Central Legislative Council was raised from 16 to 60.
- ❑ The number of members in the provincial legislative councils was not uniform.
- ❑ It retained an official majority in the Central Legislative Council but allowed the provincial legislative councils to have a non-official majority.
- ❑ It provided (for the first time) for the association of Indians with the executive councils of the Viceroy and Governors.

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- It also provided for the separate representation of presidency corporations, chambers of commerce, universities and zamindars. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**

38. (a)

Explanation:

- Indian Constitution accepts the necessity of modifications according to changing needs of society. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- Indian Constitution is not a static document, it is not the final word about everything; it is not unalterable. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**

39. (a)

Explanation:

Vanadium:

- Vanadium is a **chemical element** with the symbol **V**.
- It is a scarce element, hard, silvery grey, ductile and malleable **transition metal** with **good structural strength**.
- **Ores:**
 - Patronite, vanadinite, roscoelite and carnotite.
- **Uses:**
 - Vanadium is used primarily as an alloying element in the **Iron & Steel Industry** and to some extent as a **stabiliser in titanium and aluminium alloys used in the aerospace Industry**.
 - It imparts toughness and strength to steel, alloys and also acts as scavenger for oxygen. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
 - Modern applications of vanadium include its use as **vanadium secondary batteries for power plants and rechargeable Vanadium Redox Battery (VRB) for commercial applications**.
 - Vanadium alloys are used in **nuclear reactors** because of **vanadium's low neutron-absorbing properties**.
- **Reserves of Vanadium in Arunachal Pradesh:**
 - Concentrations of vanadium have been found in the **palaeo-proterozoic (era) carbonaceous phyllite rocks** in the **Depo and Tamang areas** of Papum Pare district in Arunachal Pradesh.

◆ **Phyllite** is a fine-grained **metamorphic rock** formed by the recrystallization of fine-grained, parent sedimentary rocks, such as mudstones or shales.

◆ Sedimentary rocks containing significant enrichment in organic matter over average sediments are called **carbonaceous sedimentary rocks**.

- There are **other potential sites in various districts** in Arunachal Pradesh.
- This is the **first report of a primary deposit of vanadium in India**.

□ **Current Scenario:**

- India is a **significant consumer of vanadium**, but is not a primary producer of the strategic metal.
- ◆ According to data provided by the GSI, India consumed **4% of total global production of Vanadium in 2017**.
- ◆ Many private players like Reliance and Vedanta, produce vanadium from slag in India. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**

40. (b)

Explanation:

- A representative government is a government of a nation with a federal structure.
- A government formed of two or more political parties is known as a Coalition government.
- A nation where the government is limited by the rules of the Constitution is called a Constitutional government.
- Parliamentary government is where the head enjoys nominal power, irrespective of his position.

Hence, option (b) is correct.

41. (c)

Explanation: International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights

- This international covenant recognises many rights that are not directly a part of the Fundamental Rights in the Indian Constitution. This has not yet become an international treaty. But human rights activists all over the world see this as a standard of human rights.
- These include:
 - the right to work: the opportunity for everyone to earn a livelihood by working;



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- right to safe and healthy working conditions, fair wages that can provide a decent standard of living for the workers and their families;
 - right to an adequate standard of living including adequate food, clothing and housing;
 - right to social security and insurance;
 - right to health: medical care during illness, special care for women during childbirth and prevention of epidemics;
 - right to education: free and compulsory primary education, equal access to higher education.
- The Right of freedom of Speech and Expression falls under Article 19 of the Indian Constitution. This right states that every citizen has the right to express his views, opinions, beliefs, and convictions freely by speech, writing, printing, or through any other methods. **Hence, option (c) is correct.**

42. (c)

Explanation:

Digital Services Tax

- On January 6, the office of the United States Trade Representative (USTR) published a report concluding that the 2 per cent digital services tax (DST) introduced by the Indian government vide the 2020 Finance Act discriminates against US businesses.
- The DST is aimed at ensuring **that non-resident, digital service providers pay their fair share of tax** on revenues generated in the Indian digital market. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- Currently, Indian double taxation avoidance agreements (tax treaties) with foreign countries do not permit the source-based taxation of business profits of non-resident companies in India in the absence of what is called a “permanent establishment” (PE).
- By definition, a PE is a fixed place of business through which the business activities of a non-resident company are carried on in India. Importantly, while non-resident, non-digital service providers pay Indian corporate tax on income attributed to a PE in India, business models employed by non-resident digital service providers obviate the need for a physical presence in India and profits attributed to the Indian market could easily escape the Indian income tax net.

- **‘Significant Economic Presence’:** The government amended the Income Tax Act to provide for a “**significant economic presence**” (to supplement physical presence) as a nexus to tax business profits of a non-resident company.
- **Significant Economic Presence (SEP):**
 - SEP introduced the Income-Tax Act, 1961 (‘ITA’) from April 1, 2018.
- **SEP is defined to mean:**
 - ◆ Transaction in respect of any goods, services or property carried out by a non-resident in India, including the provision of download of data or software in India, subject to payment threshold to be prescribed.
 - ◆ Finance Act 2018 expanded the scope of the term - ‘Business Connection’ to enable taxation of non-residents having a Significant Economic Presence (SEP) in India. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

43. (c)

Explanation:

According to the Supreme court limited amending power of parliament is one of the basic features of the Constitution and therefore, the limitations on that power cannot be destroyed. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.** Parliament **cannot**, under Article 368, expand its amending power so as to acquire for itself the right to repeal or abrogate the Constitution or to destroy its basic features. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**

Elements of the Basic Structure :

1. Supremacy of the Constitution.
2. Sovereign, democratic and republican nature of the Indian polity.
3. Secular character of the Constitution
4. Separation of powers between the legislature, the executive and the judiciary. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**
5. Federal character of the Constitution
6. Unity and integrity of the nation
7. Welfare state (socio-economic justice)
8. Judicial review
9. Freedom and dignity of the individual
10. Parliamentary system
11. Rule of law



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12. Harmony and balance between Fundamental Rights and Directive Principle
13. Principle of equality
14. Free and fair elections
15. Independence of Judiciary
16. Limited power of Parliament to amend the Constitution
17. Effective access to justice
18. Principles (or essence) underlying fundamental rights.
19. Powers of the Supreme Court under Articles 32, 136, 141 and 142
20. Powers of the High Courts under Articles 226 and 227

44. (a)

Explanation:

The Vice President of India has virtually launched “Not Many, But One”, an English translation of poems of Sree Narayana Gurudev.

Sree Narayana Gurudev

□ Birth:

- Sree Narayana Guru was born on **22nd August, 1856** to Madan Asan and his wife Kuttiamma in Chempazhanthy, a village near Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala.

□ Early Days and Education:

- His family belonged to the **Ezhava caste** and was considered ‘**avarna**’ according to the social mores of the time.
- Right from his childhood he loved **solitude and always indulged himself in deep contemplation**. He was intensely drawn to worship at the local temples and composed hymns and several devotional songs.
- From an early age, he was **drawn towards asceticism**. He lived as a hermit in a forest for **eight years**.
- He learned Vedas, Upanishads, literature, logical rhetoric of Sanskrit, Hatha **Yoga and other philosophies**.

Important Works:

□ Against Caste Injustice:

- He gave the famous slogan “**One Caste, One Religion, One God for All**” (Oru Jathi, Oru Matham,

Oru Daivam, Manushyanu). **Hence, option (a) is correct.**

- In 1888, he built a temple dedicated to **Lord Shiva at Aruvippuram** which was against the **caste-based restrictions** of the time.
- In one temple he consecrated at Kalavancode, **he kept mirrors instead of idols**. This symbolised his message that the divine was within each individual.

□ Against Conversions:

- He taught equality but felt the inequalities should not be exploited to carry out conversions and therefore generate strife in society.
- Narayana Guru organized an All-Religion Conference in 1923 at Alwaye Advaita Ashram, which was reported to be the first such event in India. This was an effort to counter the religious conversions Ezhava community was susceptible to.

□ Philosophy of Sree Narayana Guru:

- Sree Narayana Guru became one of the greatest proponents and re-evaluators of **Advaita Vedanta**, the principle of non-duality put forward by **Adi Shankara**.

□ Literary Works:

- He wrote various books in different languages. Few of them are: Advaita Deepika, Asrama, Thevarappathinkangal, etc.

□ Contribution to National Movement:

- A remarkable social reformer, he was in the forefront of the movement for **universal temple entry** and against the **societal ills like the social discrimination of untouchables**.
- Narayana Gurudev provided the impetus for **Vaikom agitation** which was aimed at **temple entry in Travancore** for the **lower castes**. It drew nationwide attention and appreciation from **Mahatma Gandhi**.
- He captured the **essence of Indianness** in his poems which highlighted the unity that lies beneath the world’s apparent diversity.

□ Contribution to Science:

- Emphasized the practice of ideals of cleanliness, promotion of education, agriculture, trade, handicrafts and technical training.
- Sree Narayana Gurudev’s **Adhyaropa darshanam** (Darsanamala) explains the **creation of the universe**.



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- **Daivadasakam** and **Atmopadesa satakam** are a few examples of how the mystic reflections and insights closely resemble **recent advances in physics**.

❑ **Current Relevance of Philosophy:**

- Gurudev's philosophy of Universal Oneness has special relevance in the contemporary global context where in the social fabric of many countries and communities are being eroded by **hatred, violence, bigotry, sectarianism and other divisive tendencies**.

❑ **Death:**

- 20th September, 1928. This day is observed as Sree Narayana Guru Samadhi in Kerala.

45. (c)

Explanation:

Article 360 empowers the president to proclaim a Financial Emergency if he is satisfied that a situation has arisen due to which the financial stability or credit of India or any part of its territory is threatened.

Once approved by both the Houses of Parliament, the Financial Emergency continues indefinitely till it is revoked. This implies two things:

1. there is no maximum period prescribed for its operation; **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
2. repeated parliamentary approval is not required for its continuation. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

46. (d)

Explanation:

- ❑ The elephant was adopted as the symbol (seal) of the Constituent Assembly. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- ❑ Sir B.N. Rau was appointed as the constitutional advisor (Legal advisor) to the Constituent Assembly. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**
- ❑ H.V.R. Iyengar was the Secretary to the Constituent Assembly. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- ❑ S.N. Mukerjee was the chief draftsman of the constitution in the Constituent Assembly. **Hence, statement 4 is correct.**
- ❑ Prem Behari Narain Raizada was the calligrapher of the Indian Constitution. The original constitution was handwritten by him in a flowing italic style.

- ❑ The original version was beautified and decorated by artists from Shantiniketan including Nand Lal Bose and Beohar Rammanohar Sinha.
- ❑ Beohar Rammanohar Sinha illuminated, beautified and ornamented the original Preamble calligraphed by Prem Behari Narain Raizada.
- ❑ The calligraphy of the Hindi version of the original constitution was done by Vasant Krishan Vaidya and elegantly decorated and illuminated by Nand Lal Bose.

47. (c)

Explanation:

Pravasi Bhartiya Divas (PBD)

❑ **Background:**

- **Pravasi Bhartiya Diwas is celebrated on 9th January** since it was **on this day in 1915 that Mahatma Gandhi, the greatest Pravasi, returned to India from South Africa**, led India's freedom struggle and changed the lives of Indians forever.

- ❑ **PBD Conventions:** These are **held once every two years. Hence, statement 1 is correct.**

- **PBD 2021:** The **16th PBD Convention** was held virtually in New Delhi. The **theme** was **"Contributing to Atma Nirbhar Bharat"**.

- **Chief Guest:** President of Suriname Chandrikapersad Santokhi.

❑ **Initiatives for Indian Diaspora:**

- **Vande Bharat Mission**, in which more than 45 lakh Indians were rescued during Corona times.
- **Skilled Workers Arrival Database for Employment Support (SWADES)**, an initiative for returning immigrants from the Gulf and other areas.
- **Global Pravasi Rishta Portal** for better connectivity and communication with the Pravasi Bharatiyas.

❑ **Pravasi Bharatiya Samman Award:**

- It is the **highest honour conferred on a Non-Resident Indian, Person of Indian Origin; or an organisation or institution established and run by Non-Resident Indians or Persons of Indian Origin**, who have made significant contribution in better understanding of India abroad, support India's causes and concerns in a tangible way, community work abroad, welfare of local Indian community, philanthropic and charitable work, etc. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**



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- During the PBD convention, select eminent Indian diaspora members are awarded the Pravasi Bharatiya Samman Awards in the presence of the President of India.
- **30 Winners of the 2021 Award:** Including **Suriname President** Chandrikapersad Santokhi, **Curacao Prime Minister** Eugene Rhuggenaath and **New Zealand minister** Priyanca Radhakrishnan.
- ❑ **Third Edition Bharat ko Janiye Quiz (2021):**
 - It was **launched in 2015-16** in order to **strengthen the engagement with young overseas Indians (18-35)** and encourage them to know more about their country of origin.
 - The first edition was held in 2015-16 and the second one in 2018-19.

48. (D)**Explanation:**

- ❑ **Parliamentary form of government** is when power is shared among **different organs of government, such as the legislature, executive and judiciary**. This is also known as the horizontal distribution of power because it allows different organs of government placed at the same level to exercise different powers.
- ❑ In the **Federal type of government**, power is shared among governments at different levels – **a general government for the entire country and governments at the provincial or regional level**.
- ❑ **Coalition Government:** Power-sharing arrangements are seen in the way **political parties**, pressure groups and movements control or influence those in power. This form is known as the Coalition government.
- ❑ **Community Government:** Power is also shared among different social groups such as the religious and linguistic groups. This sharing of power amongst social groups is called Community government. **Hence, option (D) is correct.**

49. (D)**Explanation:**

- ❑ When power is taken away from Central and State governments and given to local governments, it is called decentralisation. A vast country like India cannot be run only through two tiers, thus there arose a need for power-sharing within the States. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**

- ❑ At the local level, it is possible for the people to directly participate in decision making, helping in the improvement of people's participation. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- ❑ There were several attempts of decentralisation like Panchayats in villages and municipalities in towns, but they were controlled by the state governments. Also, regular elections did not take place. Thus stepping forward in decentralising in 1992. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**

50. (b)**Explanation:****Shram Shakti Portal**

- ❑ Recently, the **Ministry of Tribal Affairs** has launched **"ShramShakti"- a National Migration Support Portal**, to smooth the formulation of state and national level programs for migrant workers. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- A training manual **"ShramSaathi"** was also launched for migrant workers.

About the Portal:

- It has been launched to **collect data related to tribal migrant workers** and link them with the existing welfare schemes. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- ❑ **Objectives of ShramShakti Portal:**
 - **To address the data gap:**
 - ◆ Various data will be recorded via Shram Shakti include demographic profile, livelihood options, skill mapping and migration pattern.
 - ◆ It will help in empowering the workers who generally migrate in search of employment and income generation.
 - **To help in formulation of strategies:**
 - ◆ It would help the national and state governments in **formulation of effective strategies** and policy decisions for welfare of migrant workers at both source and destination states.
 - To address the various issues related to migrants:
 - ◆ Trafficking,
 - ◆ Wages harassment issues,
 - ◆ Occupational hazards at the workplace, etc.

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❑ **Linking with other schemes:**

- This portal will link the migrant population with the existing Welfare Schemes under **Atma Nirbhar Bharat**.

51. (c)

Explanation:

According to Article 51 A,

it shall be the duty of every citizen of India:

- (a) to abide by the Constitution and respect its ideals and institutions, the National Flag and the National Anthem;
- (b) to cherish and follow the noble ideals that inspired the national struggle for freedom;
- (c) to uphold and protect the sovereignty, unity and integrity of India;
- (d) to defend the country and render national service when called upon to do so; (e) to promote harmony and the spirit of common brotherhood amongst all the people of India transcending religious, linguistic and regional or sectional diversities and to renounce practices derogatory to the dignity of women;
- (f) to value and preserve the rich heritage of the country's composite culture;
- (g) to protect and improve the natural environment including forests, lakes, rivers and wildlife and to have compassion for living creatures; **Hence, option (c) is correct.**
- (h) to develop scientific temper, humanism and the spirit of inquiry and reform;
- (i) to safeguard public property and to abjure violence;
- (j) to strive towards excellence in all spheres of individual and collective activity so that the nation constantly rises to higher levels of endeavour and achievement; and
- (k) to provide opportunities for education to his child or ward between the age of six and fourteen years.

52. (b)

Explanation:

- ❑ India's **first indigenous 9mm Machine Pistol** has been jointly developed by **Infantry School, Mhow** and

DRDO's Armament Research & Development Establishment (ARDE), Pune.

- ❑ Machine pistols are primarily self-loading versions of pistols which are either fully automatic or can also fire bursts of bullets.
- ❑ The Pistol is named "**Asmi**" meaning "**Pride**", "**Self-Respect**" & "**Hard Work**".
- ❑ **Features of Asmi:**
 - The Machine Pistol fires the in-service **9mm ammunition**.
 - It has an upper receiver made from Aircraft **grade Aluminium** and lower receiver from **Carbon Fibre**.
 - **3D Printing process** has been used in designing and prototyping of various parts including trigger components made by metal 3D printing. **Hence, option (b) is correct.**

53. (d)

Explanation:

Article 263 of the Constitution of India provides for the establishment of an Inter-State Council.

Provisions with respect to an Inter-State Council – If at any time it appears to the President that the public interests would be served by the establishment of a Council charged with the duty of –

- (a) inquiring into and advising upon disputes which may have arisen between States;
- (b) investigating and discussing subjects in which some or all of the States, or the Union and one or more of the States, have a common interest; or
- (c) making recommendations upon any such subject and, in particular, recommendations for the better co-ordination of policy and action with respect to that subject,

It shall be lawful for the President by order to establish such a Council, and to define the nature of the duties to be performed by it and its organization and procedure." **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**

The Commission on Centre-State Relations under the Chairmanship of Justice R.S. Sarkaria in its report in January 1988 recommended that:

- (a) A permanent Inter-State Council called the Inter-Governmental Council (IGC) should be set up under Article 263



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- (b) The IGC should be charged with the duties set out in clauses (b) and (c) of Article 263, other than socio-economic planning and development. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

The Council consists of:-

- ❑ Prime Minister – Chairman. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**
- ❑ Chief Ministers of all States – Members
- ❑ Chief Ministers of Union Territories having a Legislative Assembly and Administrators of UTs not having a Legislative Assembly – Members
- ❑ Six Ministers of Cabinet rank in the Union Council of Ministers to be nominated by the Prime Minister – Members

54. (b)

Explanation:

Directive Principles of State Policy

- ❑ The directive principles are meant for promoting the ideal of social and economic democracy.
- ❑ They seek to establish a 'welfare state' in India. However, unlike the Fundamental Rights, the directives are non-justiciable, that is, they are not enforceable by the courts for their violation.
- ❑ The Constitution itself declares that 'these principles are fundamental in the governance of the country and it shall be the duty of the state to apply these principles in making laws. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- ❑ In the *Minerva Mills* case (1980), the Supreme Court held that 'the Indian Constitution is founded on the bedrock of the balance between the Fundamental Rights and the Directive Principles. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- ❑ The Constitution does not contain any classification of Directive Principles. However, based on their content and direction, they can be classified into three broad categories, viz, socialistic, Gandhian and liberal-intellectual. **Hence, statement 3 is NOT correct.**

55. (c)

Explanation:

Kala Utsav 2020

- ❑ **Ministry Involved:** Kala Utsav is an initiative of the Ministry of Education (MoE) to promote arts in education. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**

- ❑ This programme **was initiated** under **Rashtriya Madhyamik Shiksha Abhiyan (RMSA)**, which has now been merged with other schemes under 'Samagra Shiksha – an integrated scheme for school education'. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

- ❑ **Aim:** Kala Utsav aims at **nurturing and showcasing the artistic talent of school students** at the secondary stage in the country.

- ❑ **District/State/National Level Utsav** is structured as an **art festival** which includes performances and display of exhibits.

- ❑ **In Accordance with NCF 2005:**

- ❑ In the context of education of Arts (Music, Theatre, Dance, Visual Arts and Crafts), the initiative is guided by the recommendations of the **National Curriculum Framework 2005 (NCF-2005)**.

56. (c)

Explanation:

- ❑ Mahatma Gandhi was not a member of the Constituent Assembly. Yet there were many members who followed his vision. Years ago, writing in his magazine *Young India* in 1931, he had spelt out what he wanted the Constitution to do. **Hence, option (c) is correct.**

57. (b)

Explanation:

- ❑ Elections of the Constituent Assembly were held in 1946. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- ❑ The Constituent Assembly was made to frame and draft the Constitution of India. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- ❑ It took three years for the Assembly to frame the Constitution. Adoption of the Constitution by the Assembly happened on 26 November 1949 but came into effect on 26 January 1950. And we celebrate this day as Republic Day each year. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**
- ❑ The Assembly was dominated by the Indian National Congress, the party that led India's freedom struggle. But the Congress itself included a variety of political groups and opinions. The Assembly had many members who did not agree with the Congress. In social terms too, the Assembly represented members from different language groups, castes, classes, religions and occupations. **Hence, statement 4 is NOT correct.**



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**58. (b)****Explanation:****Ramjet**

- ❑ A Ramjet is a form of air-breathing jet engine that uses the vehicle's forward motion to compress incoming air for combustion without a rotating compressor. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- ❑ Fuel is injected in the combustion chamber where it mixes with the hot compressed air and ignites.
- ❑ A ramjet-powered vehicle requires an assisted take-off like a rocket assist to accelerate it to a speed where it begins to produce thrust.
- ❑ Ramjets work most efficiently at supersonic speeds around Mach 3 (three times the speed of sound) and can operate up to speeds of Mach 6. However, the ramjet efficiency starts to drop when the vehicle reaches hypersonic speeds. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**

Scramjet

- ❑ Scramjet engines are a type of jet engine, and rely on the combustion of fuel and an oxidizer to produce thrust. Similar to conventional jet engines, scramjet-powered aircraft carry the fuel on board, and obtain the oxidizer by the ingestion of atmospheric oxygen. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**
- ❑ A scramjet engine is an improvement over the ramjet engine as it efficiently operates at hypersonic speeds and allows supersonic combustion. Thus it is known as Supersonic Combustion Ramjet, or Scramjet.
- ❑ The Scramjet engine designed by ISRO uses Hydrogen as fuel and the Oxygen from the atmospheric air as the oxidiser.

Dual Mode Ramjet (DMRJ)

- ❑ It is a type of jet engine where a ramjet transforms into scramjet over Mach 4-8 range, which means it can efficiently operate both in subsonic and supersonic combustor modes.

59. (d)**Explanation:****Fazl Ali Commission**

- ❑ The Fazl Ali Commission was set up in 1953.
- ❑ The Commission submitted its report in September 1955 and broadly accepted language as the basis of the reorganisation of states. But, it rejected the theory of 'one language- one state'.

- ❑ It identified four major factors that can be taken into account in any scheme of reorganisation of states:

- (a) Preservation and strengthening of the unity and security of the country. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- (b) Linguistic and cultural homogeneity. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- (c) Financial, economic and administrative considerations. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**
- (d) Planning and promotion of the welfare of the people in each state as well as of the nation as a whole. **Hence, statement 4 is correct.**

60. (a)**Explanation:****Spectrum Auctions**

- ❑ Devices such as **cellphones and wireline telephones** require signals to connect from one end to another. These signals are carried on airwaves (medium of radio waves), which must be sent at **designated frequencies** to avoid any kind of **interference**.
 - Interference may prevent reception altogether, may cause only a temporary **loss of a signal**, or may affect the **quality of the sound or picture produced** by one's equipment.
- ❑ The **Union government** owns all the publicly available assets within the geographical boundaries of the country, which also include airwaves.
 - With the **expansion in the number of cellphone, wireline telephone and internet users**, the need to provide more space for the signals arises from time to time.
- ❑ To sell these assets to companies willing to set up the required infrastructure to transport these waves from one end to another, the **central government through the Telecom Regulatory Authority of India, Department of Telecom (Ministry of Communications and Information Technology)** auctions these airwaves from time to time. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
 - These airwaves are called **spectrum**, which is **subdivided into bands** which have varying frequencies.
 - All these airwaves are **sold for a certain period of time**, after which their **validity lapses**, which is generally **set at 20 years**.

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**Sixth-Generation Telecommunication Vision Group**

- ❑ Recently, the International Telecommunication Union has formed the 6G vision group for standardisation and commercialisation of the 6G technology.
- ❑ Senior researcher Choi Hyung-jin will lead the 6G standardisation and commercialisation working group.
- ❑ The group has yet to release its reports. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**

61. (a)**Explanation:****S.R. Bommai Case:**

- ❑ In 1994, a nine-judge Constitution Bench of the Supreme Court issued the historic order, which in a way put an end to the arbitrary dismissal of State governments under Article 356 by spelling out restrictions.
- ❑ The verdict concluded that the power of the President to dismiss a State government is not absolute. The verdict said the President should exercise the power only after his proclamation (imposing his/her rule) is approved by both Houses of Parliament.
- ❑ Till then, the Court said, the President can only suspend the Legislative Assembly by suspending the provisions of Constitution relating to the Legislative Assembly.
- ❑ In case both Houses of Parliament disapprove or do not approve the Proclamation, the Proclamation lapses at the end of the two-month period. In such a case, the government which was dismissed revives.
- ❑ The Legislative Assembly, which may have been kept in suspended animation gets reactivated," the Court said. Also the Court made it amply clear that a Presidential Proclamation under Article 356 is subject to judicial review.

Imposition of President's Rule in a state would be proper in the following situations:

- ❑ Where after general elections to the assembly, no party secures a majority, that is, '**Hung Assembly**'. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- ❑ Where the party having a majority in the assembly declines to form a ministry and the governor cannot find a coalition ministry commanding a majority in the assembly.
- ❑ Where a ministry resigns after its defeat in the assembly and no other party is willing or able to form a ministry commanding a majority in the assembly.

- ❑ Where a constitutional direction of the Central government is disregarded by the state government. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**

- ❑ Internal subversion where, for example, a government is deliberately acting against the Constitution and the law or is fomenting a violent revolt.

- ❑ Physical breakdown where the government wilfully refuses to discharge its constitutional obligations endangering the security of the state.

The imposition of President's Rule in a state would be improper under the following situations:

- ❑ Where a ministry resigns or is dismissed on losing majority support in the assembly and the governor recommends imposition of President's Rule without probing the possibility of forming an alternative ministry.
- ❑ Where the governor makes his own assessment of the support of a ministry in the assembly and recommends imposition of President's Rule without allowing the ministry to prove its majority on the floor of the Assembly.
- ❑ Where the ruling party enjoying majority support in the assembly has suffered a massive defeat in the general elections to the Lok Sabha such as in 1977 and 1980.
- ❑ Internal disturbances not amounting to internal subversion or physical breakdown.
- ❑ Maladministration in the state or allegations of corruption against the ministry or stringent financial exigencies of the state. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- ❑ Where the state government is not given prior warning to rectify itself except in case of extreme urgency leading to disastrous consequences.
- ❑ Where the power is used to sort out intra-party problems of the ruling party, or for a purpose extraneous or irrelevant to the one for which it has been conferred by the Constitution.
- ❑ Financial stringent exigencies

62. (a)**Explanation:****India Innovation Index 2020**

- ❑ **Institutions Involved:**
 - **NITI (National Institution for Transforming India) Ayog with the Institute for Competitiveness.****Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

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❑ Indicators Used:

- The indicators that the survey uses includes the level and quality of education and parameters such as:
- **Number of PhD students and knowledge-intensive employment.**
- Enrolment in **engineering and technology** and number of **highly skilled professionals.**
- Investment in **R&D** and number of patents and trademark applications filed.
- **Internet subscribers. Hence, statement 3 is correct.**
- **FDI inflows, business environment and safety and legal environment.**

- ❑ **Categories:** The Innovation Index is divided into three categories—**major states, Union Territories, and hill and North East states.**

Best performers			
Four of the five highest scoring major States in the India Innovation Index are from the south			
Rank	Major States	Score	
1	Karnataka	42.5	
2	Maharashtra	38.03	
3	Tamil Nadu	37.91	
4	Telangana	33.23	
5	Kerala	30.58	
6	Haryana	25.81	
7	Andhra Pradesh	24.19	
8	Gujarat	23.63	
9	Uttar Pradesh	22.85	
10	Punjab	22.54	

❑ Major States:

- **Top States: Karnataka topped with a score of 42.5 for the second year running. Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- ◆ The state's success has been attributed to a high number of **venture capital deals, registered GIs and ICT exports, and high FDI inflow.**
- ◆ Four southern states – **Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Telangana and Kerala** —occupy the top positions on the index, apart from **Maharashtra which ranked second.**

- ❑ **Bottom States: Jharkhand, Chhattisgarh and Bihar** scored the lowest on the index, which put them at the bottom in the “major States” category.

- **Bihar raked last with 14.5 points.**

❑ Hill and North-East States:

- **Himachal Pradesh topped the rankings** of hill and North-East states, followed by Uttarakhand,

Manipur and Sikkim.

❑ Union territories/Small States:

- **Delhi has scored the highest on the index** in the country with a score of 46.6, while **Lakshadweep has the lowest score at 11.7.**
- ◆ Delhi recorded the highest number of **trademark and patent applications**, along with the establishment of **new start-ups and companies** in the last financial year.

63. (D)

Explanation: Functions of the constitution:

- ❑ The constitution provides a set of basic rules that allow for minimal coordination amongst members of society. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- ❑ It specifies who has the power to make decisions in a society. It decides how the government will be constituted. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- ❑ The constitution set some limits on what a government can impose on its citizens. These limits are fundamental in the sense that the government may never trespass them.
- ❑ It enables the government to fulfil the aspirations of a society and create conditions for a just society. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**

64. (c)

Explanation:

- ❑ In 1950, the Constitution contained a four-fold classification of the states of the Indian Union—Part A, Part B, Part C and Part D State. In all, they numbered 29.
- ❑ Part-A states comprised nine erstwhile governor's provinces of British India. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- ❑ Part-B states consisted of nine erstwhile princely states with legislatures. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- ❑ Part-C states consisted of erstwhile chief commissioner's provinces of British India and some of the erstwhile princely states. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**
- ❑ These Part-C states (in all 10 in number) were centrally administered.
- ❑ The Andaman and Nicobar Islands were kept as the solitary Part-D state.



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**65. (c)****Explanation:****Natural Capital**

- ❑ The term natural capital is attributed to economist E.F Schumacher, who presented the concept in his 1973 book *Small is Beautiful*.
- ❑ Natural capital is another term for the stock of renewable and non-renewable resources (e.g. plants, animals, air, water, soils, minerals) that combine to yield a flow of benefits to people.

Natural Capital Accounting

- ❑ Natural capital accounting (NCA) is an umbrella term covering efforts to use an accounting framework to provide a systematic way to measure and report on stocks and flows of natural capital. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- ❑ Its underlying premise is that since the environment is important to society and the economy, it should be recognised as an asset that must be maintained and managed, and its contributions (services) be better integrated into commonly used frameworks like the System of National Accounts.
- ❑ NCA covers accounting for individual environmental assets or resources, both **biotic and abiotic (such as water, minerals, energy, timber, fish)**, as well as accounting for **ecosystem assets (e.g. forests; wetlands)**, biodiversity and ecosystem services..

Environmental-economic accounts

- ❑ Environmental-economic accounts are integrated statistics that tell about the relationship between the environment and the economy.
- ❑ It tells about the impacts of the economy on the environment and the contribution of the environment to the economy.
- ❑ Environmental-economic accounts can provide information about the extraction of natural resources, their use within the economy, natural resource stock levels, the changes in those stocks during a specific period and economic activity related to the environment.
- ❑ Environmental-economic accounts present this information in physical and monetary terms, as appropriate.

System of Environmental Economic Accounting (SEEA)

- ❑ The System of Environmental Economic Accounting

(SEEA) is the accepted international standard for environmental-economic accounting, providing a framework for organizing and presenting statistics on the environment and its relationship with the economy.

- ❑ It brings together economic and environmental information in an internationally agreed set of standard concepts, definitions, classifications, accounting rules and tables to produce internationally comparable statistics.
- ❑ The SEEA is produced and released under the auspices of the United Nations, the European Commission, the Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations, the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development, International Monetary Fund and the World Bank Group. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

66. (c)**Explanation:**

- ❑ Despite the unitary bias of the Indian Constitution, there are important constitutionally embedded differences between the legal status and prerogatives of different subunits within the same federation.
- ❑ Indian federalism has been constitutionally asymmetric. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- ❑ To meet the specific needs and requirements of some sub-units, it was always part of the original design to have a unique relationship with them or to give them special status. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- ❑ Under Article 371A, the privilege of special status was also accorded to the North-Eastern State of Nagaland.
- ❑ This Article not only confers validity on pre-existing laws within Nagaland but also protects local identity through restrictions on immigration.
- ❑ Many other States are beneficiaries of such special provisions.

67. (b)**Explanation:****Kanha Tiger Reserve**

- ❑ **Location:** It stretches over an area of 940 square km in the **two districts - Mandla and Balaghat - of Madhya Pradesh**. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**
- ❑ **History:** The present-day Kanha area was divided into two sanctuaries, **Hallon and Banjar**. **Kanha National Park was created in 1955** and in **1973** was made the **Kanha Tiger Reserve**.

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- Kanha National Park is the **largest National Park in Central India**.

❑ **Features:**

○ **Fauna:**

- ◆ The **State animal of Madhya Pradesh - Hard Ground Barasingha (Swamp deer or *Rucervus duvaucelii*)** is found **exclusively** in Kanha Tiger Reserve.
- ◆ Swamp Deer or Barasingha is also called the 'jewel of Kanha'. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- ◆ Other Species found include **Tiger**, Leopard, Dhole, Bear, **Gaur** and Indian Python etc.

❑ **Flora:**

- It is best known for its evergreen **Sal forests (*Shorea Robusta*)**.
- It is the **first tiger reserve in India to officially introduce a mascot, "Bhoorsingh the Barasingha"**. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**

❑ **Other Tiger Reserves in Madhya Pradesh:**

- **Sanjay-Dubri** ○ **Satpura**
- **Panna**

68. (c)

Explanation:

Drafting Committee

- ❑ Among all the committees of the Constituent Assembly, the most important committee was the Drafting Committee set up on August 29, 1947.
- ❑ It was this committee that was entrusted with the task of preparing a draft of the new Constitution. It consisted of seven members. They were:
 1. Dr. B R Ambedkar (Chairman)
 2. N. Gopalaswamy Ayyangar
 3. Alladi Krishnaswamy Ayyar
 4. Dr. K M Munshi
 5. Syed Mohammad Saadullah
 6. N. Madhava Rau (He replaced B L Mitter who resigned due to ill-health)
 7. T.T. Krishnamachari (He replaced D P Khaitan who died in 1948)
- ❑ G.V. Mavalankar was the chairman of the Committee on the Functions of the Constituent Assembly (Minor committee). He was also the Speaker of the Constituent Assembly (Legislative) and the Provisional Parliament (1947-52) and the First Lok Sabha (1952-56).

- ❑ Jawaharlal Nehru was the chairman of 3 Major committees:

Union Powers Committee, Union Constitution Committee, States Committee (Committee for Negotiating with States).

Hence, option (c) is correct.

69. (d)

Explanation:

- ❑ **Domestic Systemically Important Banks (D-SIBs)**
The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** has retained **State Bank of India, ICICI Bank and HDFC Bank as Domestic Systemically Important Banks (D-SIBs)**. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- ❑ **Systemically Important Banks (SIBs):**
 - Some banks, due to their **size, cross-jurisdictional activities, complexity, lack of substitutability and interconnectedness**, become **systemically important**.
 - SIBs are perceived as banks that are **'Too Big To Fail (TBTF)'**. This perception of TBTF creates an **expectation of government support for these banks** at the time of distress. It is not an obligation. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
 - SIBs are **subjected to additional policy measures** to deal with the **systemic risks and moral hazard** issues posed by them.
 - **Systemic risk** can be defined as the risk associated with the collapse or failure of a company, industry, financial institution or an entire economy.
 - **Moral hazard** is a situation in which one party gets involved in a risky event knowing that it is protected against the risk and the other party will incur the cost.
- ❑ The disorderly failure of these banks has the **potential to cause significant disruption to the essential services** they provide to the banking system, and in turn, to the **overall economic activity**.

70. (d)

Explanation:

Recently, the government decided to allocate 30% of the North-Eastern Council's (NEC's) budget for developing deprived areas.

- ❑ It is a statutory advisory body established under the North Eastern Council Act, 1971, as amended in 2002. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**



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- ❑ It is the nodal agency for economic and social development of 8 North Eastern Region States of Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Manipur, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Nagaland, Sikkim and Tripura.
- ❑ **Organisation structure includes:**
 1. Ex-officio Chairman – Union Home Minister. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
 2. Vice Chairman - Minister of State (Independent Charge), Ministry of DoNER
 3. Members - Governors and Chief Ministers of all the eight States and 3 members nominated by the President.
 4. It is mandated to function as a Regional Planning Body for the North Eastern Region.
 5. While formulating the regional plans, it needs to give priority to schemes and projects, benefitting two or more States, provided that in case of Sikkim, the Council shall formulate specific projects and schemes for that State.

71. (b)

Explanation:

Gobind Ballabh Pant

- ❑ G.B. Pant was born on 10th September 1887 in Uttarakhand, at Almora.
- ❑ He was the **Premier of United Provinces (1937 - 1939)**, First Chief Minister of Uttar Pradesh (1946 -1954) and Union Home Minister (1955 - 1961) and was a recipient of the highest civilian award, the Bharat Ratna in 1957. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- ❑ In 1907, he decided to study law, after receiving his degree, he started to practise law in Almora in 1910 and eventually moved to Kashipur.
- ❑ In Kashipur, **he established an organisation called Prem Sabha**, that started working towards several reforms and also saved a school from shutting down due to non payment of taxes to the British government. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

Contribution in National Movement

- ❑ Govind Ballabh Pant joined the Congress in December 1921 and soon joined the non- cooperation movement.
- ❑ In 1930, he was imprisoned for organizing a Salt March inspired by Gandhi's earlier actions.
- ❑ **He was elected to the Uttar Pradesh (then known as United Provinces) Legislative Assembly as the candidate of the Swarajist Party from Nainital.**

- ❑ When in Government, he tried to bring in reforms which would do away with the Zamindari system.
- ❑ He also pleaded to the Government for lowering agricultural taxes on farmers.
- ❑ He encouraged many cottage industries in the country and raised his voice against the coolie-beggar law, which forced porters to transport the heavy luggage of British officials without any payment.
- ❑ **Pant was always against a separate electorate for minorities, saying the step would further divide communities. Hence, statement 3 is NOT correct.**
- ❑ In 1942 he was arrested for signing the Quit India resolution, and spent three years in Ahmednagar Fort along with other members of the Congress working committee until March 1945.

Post Independence

- ❑ After independence, Govind Ballabh Pant became **the Chief Minister of Uttar Pradesh**. He worked for the upliftment of the farmers and the eradication of untouchability.
- ❑ After the death of Sardar Patel, Govind Ballabh Pant was made the **Home Minister** in the Union Government.
- ❑ As a Home Minister, he championed the cause of Hindi as the national language or rashtrabhasha.

72. (c)

Explanation:

The Supreme Court in the Bommai case (1994) enlisted the situations where the exercise of power under Article 356 could be proper or improper.

Imposition of President's Rule in a state would be proper in the following situations:

1. Where after general elections to the assembly, no party secures a majority, that is, 'Hung Assembly'. **Hence, option 3 is correct.**
2. Where the party having a majority in the assembly declines to form a ministry and the governor cannot find a coalition ministry commanding a majority in the assembly.
3. Where a ministry resigns after its defeat in the assembly and no other party is willing or able to form a ministry commanding a majority in the assembly.
4. Where a constitutional direction of the Central government is disregarded by the state government.



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5. Internal subversion where, for example, a government is deliberately acting against the Constitution and the law or is fomenting a violent revolt.
6. Physical breakdown where the government wilfully refuses to discharge its constitutional obligations endangering the security of the state.

73. (D)**Explanation:**

- ❑ Classical liberalism always privileges the rights of the individuals over demands of social justice and community values. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- ❑ Indian liberalism is always linked to social justice. The best example of this is the provision for reservations for Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes in the Constitution. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**

Liberal Conception of State

- ❑ The liberal state focuses on individual rights and freedom. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**
- ❑ It also argues for a neutral and minimal state.
- ❑ It replaces the divine right theory of the state and argues that a legitimate rule must be based on the consent of the people.

74. (c)**Explanation:**

- ❑ Indian laws do follow a uniform code in most civil matters — Indian Contract Act, Civil Procedure Code, Sale of Goods Act, Transfer of Property Act, Partnership Act, Evidence Act, etc. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- ❑ States, however, have made hundreds of amendments and, therefore, in certain matters, there is diversity even under these secular civil laws. Recently, several states refused to be governed by the uniform Motor Vehicles Act, 2019.
- ❑ In India “personal laws” are mentioned in the Concurrent List. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

75. (b)**Explanation:****Major Committees****The Constituent Assembly****appointed eight major committees.**

- ❑ Union Powers Committee – Jawaharlal Nehru
- ❑ Union Constitution Committee – Jawaharlal Nehru

Hence, pair 1 is NOT correctly matched.

- ❑ Provincial Constitution Committee – Sardar Patel. **Hence, pair 3 is correctly matched.**
- ❑ Drafting Committee – Dr B.R. Ambedkar
- ❑ Advisory Committee on Fundamental Rights, Minorities and Tribal and Excluded Areas – Sardar Patel.
- ❑ Rules of Procedure Committee – Dr Rajendra Prasad. **Hence, pair 2 is correctly matched.**
- ❑ States Committee (Committee for Negotiating with States) – Jawaharlal Nehru
- ❑ Steering Committee – Dr Rajendra Prasad

76. (c)**Explanation:****Corporate Average Fuel Efficiency Regulations**

- ❑ CAFE or Corporate Average Fuel Efficiency/Economy regulations are in force in many advanced as well as developing nations, including India.
- ❑ They aim at **lowering fuel consumption** (or improving fuel efficiency) of vehicles by **lowering Carbon dioxide (CO₂) emissions**, thus serving the twin purposes of **reducing dependence on oil for fuel and controlling pollution**. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- ❑ Corporate Average refers to sales-volume weighted average for **every auto manufacturer**. The idea of CAFE is to push manufacturers to achieve fuel efficiency targets by producing and selling more fuel-efficient models, including electric vehicles. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**

77. (d)**Explanation:**

- ❑ Article 275(1) is concerned with grants-in-aid. While the Finance Commission is a body set up under Article 280 of the Constitution. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- ❑ Its primary job is to recommend measures and methods on how revenues need to be distributed between the Centre and states.
- ❑ There are no-ex officio members of the commission as such. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- ❑ Besides suggesting the mechanism to share tax revenues, the Commission also lays down the principles for giving out grant-in-aid to states and other local bodies.
- ❑ The commission has to take on itself the job of addressing the imbalances that often arise between the taxation powers and expenditure responsibilities of the centre and the states, respectively.

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**78. (d)****Explanation:**

- ❑ Bustards are large, **terrestrial birds** that belong to several species, including some of the largest flying birds. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- ❑ **Two Distinct Species of Houbara Bustard:** The **International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN)** recognises two distinct species found in:
 - **North Africa (*Chlamydotis undulata*)** and
 - **Asia (*Chlamydotis macqueenii*).**
- ❑ **Habitat of Asian Houbara:**
 - The population of the Asian houbara bustards extends from northeast Asia, across central Asia, the Middle East, and the Arabian Peninsula to reach the Sinai desert (Egypt).
 - After breeding in the spring, the Asian bustards migrate south to spend the winter in Pakistan, the Arabian Peninsula and nearby Southwest Asia.
- ❑ **Reasons for Decline:** Poaching, unregulated hunting, along with degradation of its natural habitat.
- ❑ **Conservation Status:**
 - **IUCN Status-** Vulnerable
 - ◆ **IUCN Status of Great Indian Bustard is Critically Endangered. Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
 - ◆ **Convention on International Trade in Endangered Species of Wild Fauna and Flora (CITES)- Appendix I**
 - ◆ **Convention on the Conservation of Migratory Species of Wild Animals (CMS)- Appendix II**

79. (b)**Explanation:**

- ❑ The Parliamentary system of government is the one in which the executive is responsible to the legislature for its policies and acts. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- ❑ The Parliamentary government is also known as cabinet government or responsible government or Westminster model of government. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- ❑ It is prevalent in Britain, Japan, Canada, India. While presidential government is prevalent in USA, Brazil, Russia, Sri Lanka, etc. **Hence, statement 3 is NOT correct.**

80. (a)**Explanation:****Sea Vigil Exercise**

- ❑ It is a biennial pan-India **coastal defence exercise. Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- ❑ It involves all the 13 coastal States and Union Territories along with other maritime stakeholders, including the fishing and coastal communities.
 - 13 Coastal States and UTs: Gujarat, Maharashtra, Goa, Karnataka, Kerala, Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh, Odisha, West Bengal, Daman & Diu, Puducherry, Andaman & Nicobar Islands (Bay of Bengal) and Lakshadweep Islands (Arabian Sea).
- ❑ Assets of the Indian Navy, Coast Guard, Customs and other maritime agencies are participating in the Exercise.
- ❑ The Indian Air Force, National Security Guard, the Border Security Force, oil handling agencies and airports also participate in the exercise.

Exercise Kavach

- ❑ A Tri service Military 'Exercise Kavach' was conducted in January 2021 under the aegis of the Andaman and Nicobar Command (ANC), the only Joint Forces Command of the country. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- ❑ The Andaman and Nicobar Command (ANC) is the first integrated theatre command in India with headquarters at Port Blair.
- ❑ Participation: Indian Army, Indian Navy, Indian Air Force and Indian Coast Guard.

Desert Knight II

- ❑ It is the joint air defence exercise of the **Indian and French Air Force. Hence, statement 3 is NOT correct.**

81. (a)**Explanation:****Directives based on Socialist Principles:**

1. To promote the welfare of the people by securing a social order permeated by justice—social, economic and political—and to minimise inequalities in income, status, facilities and opportunities (Article 38).
2. To secure (a) the right to adequate means of livelihood for all citizens; (b) the equitable distribution of material resources of the community for the common good; (c) prevention of

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- concentration of wealth and means of production;
 (d) equal pay for equal work for men and women;
 (e) preservation of the health and strength of workers and children against forcible abuse; and
 (f) opportunities for the healthy development of children (Article 39).
- To promote equal justice and to provide free legal aid to the poor (Article 39 A). **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
 - To secure the right to work, education and public assistance in cases of unemployment, old age, sickness and disablement (Article 41).
 - To make provision for just and humane conditions of work and maternity relief (Article 42).
 - To secure a living wage, a decent standard of life and social and cultural opportunities for all workers (Article 43). **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
 - To take steps to secure the participation of workers in the management of industries (Article 43 A).
 - To raise the level of nutrition and the standard of living of people and to improve public health (Article 47).

82. (c)

Explanation:

- Recently, Gulf states signed a 'solidarity and stability' deal at the 41st Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC) summit held in Al Ula, Saudi Arabia. **Hence, option (c) is correct.**

83. (b)

Explanation:

- National Atomic Time Scale:**
 - The National Atomic Time Scale generates **Indian Standard Time** with an accuracy of **2.8 nanoseconds**. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
 - The **longitude of 82°30' E** has been selected as the 'standard meridian' of India against which the Indian Standard Time is set.
 - Now **Indian Standard Time** is matching the **International Standard Time** with the accuracy range of less than **3 nanoseconds**.

- CSIR-NPL** is the **National Measurement Institute of India** and authorized (by an act of Parliament) to realize and **maintain the Indian Standard Time (IST)**.
- IST is realized at CSIR-NPL through the **National Primary Time Scale** consisting of a bank of **ultra-stable atomic clocks**.
- CSIR-NPL is on a **mission to synchronize all the clocks in the nation to IST for securing digital infrastructure and reducing cyber crime**.
- CSIR-NPL is strengthening the **national timing infrastructure of India**, where a very rough estimate shows an economic impact of more than **10% of GDP**.

Benefits:

- This will be a big help for organizations like **Indian Space Research Organisation** who are working with cutting edge technology. **Banking, railways, defense, health, telecom, weather forecast, disaster management, Industry 4.0** and many similar sectors will be benefited greatly from this achievement.

Bhartiya Nirdeshak Dravya Pranali (BND):

- These are Indian reference materials developed by **CSIR-NPL**. It is committed to ensure the **quality of products in every manufacturing and consumer sector** by providing **SI traceable measurements** and enhancing quality life of citizens through metrology.
- SI system is used to describe units of measurement in the International System (from French 'Système International').
- Reference materials (RM) play a pivotal role in maintaining the **quality infrastructure** of any economy through **testing and calibration** with precise measurements traceable to SI units. NPLI has recently released two very important certified RMs as Bharatiya Nirdeshak Dravyas (BNDs) for **purity of gold and for Bituminous coal**. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**

84. (c)

Explanation:

The Central government has constituted the Delimitation Commission for the purpose of delimitation of Assembly



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and Parliamentary constituencies in the Union territory of Jammu and Kashmir and the States of Assam, Arunachal Pradesh, Manipur and Nagaland.

- ❑ Delimitation literally means the act or process of fixing limits or boundaries of territorial constituencies in a country or a province having a legislative body.
- ❑ **Under Article 82**, the Parliament enacts a Delimitation Act after every Census which establishes a Delimitation Commission.
- ❑ **Under Article 170**, States also get divided into territorial constituencies as per Delimitation Act after every Census.
- ❑ In India, such Delimitation Commissions have been constituted 4 times – in 1952, 1963, 1973 and 2002.
- ❑ The Delimitation Commission is appointed by the President of India and works in collaboration with the Election Commission of India. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- ❑ **The commission has three ex-officio members:**
 1. a serving or retired judge of the Supreme Court as the chairperson,
 2. the Chief Election Commissioner or the Election Commissioner nominated by the CEC and
 3. State Election Commissioner of the concerned state.
- ❑ The Delimitation Commission in India is a high power body whose orders have the force of law and cannot be called in question before any court.
- ❑ These orders come into force on a date to be specified by the President of India.
- ❑ The copies of its orders are laid before the House of the People and the State Legislative Assembly concerned, but no modifications are permissible therein by them. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- ❑ **Its functions include:**
 1. Determining the number and boundaries of constituencies to make the population of all constituencies nearly equal and providing equal representation to equal segments of a population.
 2. Identifying seats reserved for Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes, wherever their population is relatively large.

85. (b)

Explanation:

Under the Indian constitution, certain fundamental rights are available only to the citizens, namely:

- ❑ Right against discrimination on the grounds of religion, race, caste, sex or place of birth. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- ❑ Right to equality of opportunity in matters of public employment. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- ❑ Freedom of speech and expression, assembly, association, movement, residence and profession;
- ❑ Cultural and educational rights

Fundamental Rights (available to citizens as well foreigners) (except enemy aliens)

- ❑ Equality before law. **Hence, statement 3 is NOT correct.**
- ❑ Protection in respect of conviction for offences.
- ❑ Protection of personal life and liberty.
- ❑ Right to elementary education.
- ❑ Protection against arrest and detention in certain cases.
- ❑ Prohibition of human trafficking and forced labour.
- ❑ Prohibition of employment of children in factories.
- ❑ Freedom of conscience and free profession, practice and propagation of religion.
- ❑ Freedom to manage religious affairs.
- ❑ Freedom from payment of taxes for promotion of any religion.
- ❑ Freedom from attending religious instruction or worship in certain educational institutions.

86. (b)

Explanation:

Lala Lajpat Rai

❑ **About:**

- He was born on **28th January, 1865** in a small village named **Dhudike in Punjab's Ferozepur district.**
- He was also called '**Punjab Kesari**' and '**Lion of Punjab**'.
- He **studied law** at the Government College, Lahore.
- Was **influenced by Swami Dayananda Saraswati** and joined the Arya Samaj in Lahore.
- He believed that the **ideals in Hinduism combined with nationalism will lead to the establishment of a secular state.**
- Along with Bipin Chandra Pal and Bal Gangadhar Tilak, **he formed the Lal-Bal-Pal trio of extremist leaders in Indian National Congress.**



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- He was also **involved with the Hindu Mahasabha**.
 - He **fought against untouchability**.
 - ❑ **Contributions:**
 - **Political:**
 - ◆ He **joined the Indian National Congress (INC)** and participated in many political agitations in Punjab.
 - ◆ For his political agitation, **he was deported to Burma without trial in 1907** but returned after a few months because of lack of evidence.
 - ◆ He was **opposed to the partition of Bengal**.
 - ◆ He **founded the Home Rule League of America in 1917** in New York. In the USA, he worked to get moral support for the Indian independence movement from the international community.
 - ◆ He was also elected **President of the All India Trade Union Congress**.
 - ◆ He **supported the non-cooperation movement** of Gandhi at the Nagpur session of the Congress in 1920.
 - ◆ He **protested against the Rowlatt Act** and the **Jallianwala Bagh massacre** that followed.
 - ◆ He was elected **deputy leader of the Central Legislative Assembly in 1926**.
 - ◆ In 1928, he moved a resolution in the assembly **refusing cooperation with the Simon Commission** since the Commission had no Indian members.
 - ❑ **Social:**
 - He founded **Hindu Relief movement in 1897** to provide help to the famine-stricken people and thus preventing them falling into the clutches of the missionaries.
 - He founded the **Servants of People Society in 1921**.
- Hence, option (b) is correct.**
- ❑ **Literary:**
 - His important literary works include **Young India**, **England's Debt to India**, **Evolution of Japan**, **India's Will to Freedom**, **Message of the Bhagavad Gita**, **Political Future of India**, **Problem of National Education in India**, **The Depressed Glasses**, and the travelogue '**United States of America**'.
 - He was the author of the biographies of **Mazzini**, **Garibaldi**, **Shivaji** and **Shri Krishna**.

❑ **Institutional:**

- He founded several institutions and organizations such as **Hisar Bar Council**, **Hisar Arya Samaj**, **Hisar Congress**, **National DAV Managing Committee**.
- He was the **editor of the Arya Gazette**, which he had founded.
- He co-founded the **Punjab National Bank in 1894**.

❑ **Death:**

- In 1928, he was leading a **silent protest against the Simon Commission** in Lahore when he was brutally **lathi-charged by Superintendent of Police, James Scott**. He died of injuries sustained a few weeks later.

87. (d)

Explanation:

Only the Chief Election Commissioner is provided with security of tenure. He cannot be removed from his office except in the same manner and on the same grounds as a judge of the Supreme Court. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**

Though the constitution has sought to safeguard and ensure the independence and impartiality of the Election Commission, some flaws can be noted, viz.,

- ❑ The Constitution has not prescribed the qualifications be they legal, educational, administrative or judicial of the members of the Election Commission. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- ❑ The Constitution has not specified the term of the members of the Election Commission.
- ❑ The Constitution has not debarred the retiring election commissioners from any further appointment by the government.

88. (c)

Explanation:

The Constitution guarantees the right to protest and express dissent, but with an obligation towards certain duties.

- ❑ It is implicit in Article 19(1)(a), which guarantees the freedom of speech and expression, and in Article 19(1)(b), the right to assemble peacefully. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**



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- ❑ It is integral to the right to protection of life and personal liberty enshrined in Article 21. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

89. (b)

Explanation:

Pangolins

- ❑ Pangolins are scaly anteater mammals and they have large, protective keratin scales covering their skin.
- ❑ They are also toothless and nocturnal and when threatened, they curl up into a tight ball.

Diet:

- **Insectivore-** Pangolins are nocturnal, and their diet consists of mainly ants and termites, which they capture using their long tongues.

Hence, statement 2 is correct.

❑ **Types**

- Out of the eight species of pangolin, the Indian Pangolin (*Manis crassicaudata*) and the Chinese Pangolin (*Manis pentadactyla*) are found in India.

❑ **Difference:**

- Indian Pangolin is a large anteater covered by 11-13 rows of scales on the back.
- A terminal scale is also present on the lower side of the tail of the Indian Pangolin, which is absent in the Chinese Pangolin.

❑ **Habitat:**

- **Indian Pangolin:** It is widely distributed in India, except the arid region, high Himalayas and the North-East.
- The species is also found in Bangladesh, Pakistan, Nepal and Sri Lanka. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- **Chinese Pangolin:** It is found in the Himalayan foothills in Eastern Nepal, Bhutan, Northern India, North-East Bangladesh and through Southern China.
- **African Pangolin:** They prefer sandy soils and can be found in woodlands and savannas that are within reach of water. They are dispersed throughout Southern, Central, and East Africa.
- They are not found in North or South America.

❑ **Threats to Pangolins in India:**

- Hunting and poaching for local consumptive use (e.g. as a protein source and traditional medicine)

and international trade for its meat and scales in East and South East Asian countries, particularly China and Vietnam.

- They are believed to be the world's most trafficked mammal.

Conservation Status:

- ❑ **Wildlife Protection Act, 1972:** Schedule I
- ❑ **IUCN Red List:** There are eight species of pangolins. **Four are found in Asia—Chinese, Sunda, Indian, and Philippine pangolins**—and they're listed by the IUCN as **critically endangered**. The **four African species—the ground pangolin, giant pangolin, white-bellied, and black-bellied**—are listed as **vulnerable**. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**
- ❑ **CITES:** Appendix I

90. (a)

Explanation:

Portfolio system

- ❑ Indian Councils Act of 1861 gave recognition to the 'portfolio' system. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- ❑ It was introduced by Lord Canning in 1859. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- ❑ Under this, a member of the Viceroy's council was made in charge of one or more departments of the government and was authorised to issue final orders on behalf of the council on matters of his department(s).

91. (d)

Explanation:

State of the Climate Report 2020

Recently, the India Meteorological Department (IMD) has released the 'State of the Climate Report', for the year 2020. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**

- ❑ The State of the Climate Report looks at temperature and rainfall trends annually.

Key Points

❑ **Eighth Warmest Year 2020:**

○ **Average Temperature:**

- ◆ During the year, the annual average temperature in the country was 0.29 degree Celsius (°C) above normal (29-year average from 1981-2010).
- ◆ However, it was much lower than 2016 (+0.71 degrees Celsius), which remains the warmest ever year the country has recorded since 1901. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**



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❑ Warmest Years over India:

- The eight warmest years on record in order were: **2016 (+ 0.71 degree C) > 2009 (+0.55 degree C) > 2017 (+0.541 degree C) > 2010 (+0.539 degrees C) > 2015 (+0.42 degree C) > 2018 (+0.41 degree C) > 2019 (+0.36 degree C) > 2020 (+0.29 degree C).**
- The past decade (2011-2020) was the warmest on record.

❑ Extreme Weather Events:

- Extremely heavy rain, floods, cold waves and thunderstorms led to significant loss of lives and properties.
- According to the report “Preparing India for Extreme Climate Events” released by the Council on Energy, Environment and Water (CEEW), over **75% of districts in India are hotspots of extreme climate events. Hence, statement 3 is NOT correct.**
- Uttar Pradesh and Bihar reported the highest casualties due to cold waves, lightning and thunder last year.

❑ Data on Rainfall:

- The annual rainfall over the country in 2020 was 109% of the Long Period Average (LPA) calculated for the period of 1961-2010.

92. (c)

Explanation:

Prevention of Cruelty to Animals Act, 1960

- ❑ The legislative intent of the Act is to “prevent the infliction of unnecessary pain or suffering on animals”.
- ❑ The **Animal Welfare Board of India (AWBI)** was established in 1962 under Section 4 of the Act. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- ❑ This Act provides for **punishment for causing unnecessary cruelty** and suffering to animals.
- ❑ The Act defines animals and different forms of animals.
 - ‘**animal**’ means any living creature other than a human being. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
 - ‘**captive animal**’ means any animal (not being a domestic animal) which is in captivity or confinement
 - ‘**domestic animal**’ means any animal which is tamed or which has been or is being sufficiently tamed to serve some purpose for the use of man

- ❑ Discusses different forms of cruelty, exceptions, and killing of a suffering animal in case any cruelty has been committed against it, so as to relieve it from further suffering.
- ❑ Provides the guidelines relating to experimentation on animals for scientific purposes.
- ❑ The Act enshrines the provisions relating to the exhibition of the performing animals, and offences committed against the performing animals.
- ❑ This Act provides for the limitation period of 3 months beyond which no prosecution shall lie for any offences under this Act.

93. (b)

Explanation:

World Food Price Index

The Food and Agriculture Organization’s (FAO) food price index averaged **107.5 points in December 2020, up 2.3 points from November 2020. Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**

- ❑ This marks the **seventh month of consecutive increase.**
- ❑ **About the Index:**
 - It was **introduced in 1996** as a public good to help in monitoring developments in the **global agricultural commodity markets.**
 - **The FAO Food Price Index (FFPI) is a measure of the monthly change in international prices of a basket of food commodities. Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
 - It measures changes for a **basket of cereals, oilseeds, dairy products, meat and sugar.**
 - **Base Period: 2014-16.**
- ❑ **About the Food and Agriculture Organization:**
 - FAO is a **specialized agency of the United Nations** that leads international efforts to defeat hunger.
 - **World Food Day** is celebrated every year around the world on **16th October**. The day is celebrated to mark the **anniversary of the founding of the FAO in 1945**
 - ◆ **India released a commemorative coin of Rs. 75 denomination to mark the 75th Anniversary of the FAO (16th October 2020).**
 - It is **one of the UN food aid organisations based in Rome (Italy)**. Its sister bodies are the **World Food Programme** and the **International Fund for Agricultural Development (IFAD)**.



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❑ Initiatives Taken:

- **Globally Important Agricultural Heritage Systems (GIAHS).**
- Monitors the **Desert Locust situation** throughout the world.
- The **Codex Alimentarius Commission or CAC** is the body responsible for all matters regarding the implementation of the Joint FAO/WHO Food Standards Programme.
- The **International Treaty on Plant Genetic Resources for Food and Agriculture** was adopted by the Thirty-First Session of the Conference of the Food and Agriculture Organization in 2001.

❑ Flagship Publications:

- The State of World Fisheries and Aquaculture (SOFIA).
- The State of the World's Forests (SOFO).
- **The State of Food Security and Nutrition in the World (SOFI).**
- The State of Food and Agriculture (SOFA).
- The State of Agricultural Commodity Markets (SOCO).

94. (c)

Explanation:

Significance of the S.R. Bommai vs Union of India case:

- ❑ The case put an end to the arbitrary dismissal of State governments by a hostile Central government.
- ❑ The verdict also categorically ruled that the floor of the Assembly is the only forum that should test the majority of the government of the day, and not the subjective opinion of the Governor, who is often referred to as the agent of the Central government. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- ❑ The verdict concluded that the power of the President to dismiss a State government is not absolute. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- ❑ The verdict said the President should exercise the power only after his proclamation (imposing his/her rule) is approved by both Houses of Parliament.

95. (c)

Explanation:

Dzukou Valley

- ❑ **Location:** The Dzukou Valley, popularly known as the 'valley of flower', is located at the **border of Nagaland and Manipur. Hence, statement 1 is correct.**

Features:

- ❑ Situated at an **altitude of 2,438** metres behind the Japfu mountain range, it is one of the most popular trekking spots in the North East.
- ❑ **Dzukou valley and Japfu peak are located adjacent to the Pulie Badze Wildlife Sanctuary (Nagaland).**
- ❑ It is home to rare and 'vulnerable' (as per the IUCN Red List) birds - **Blyth's Tragopan (Nagaland's state bird)**, the **Rufous-necked Hornbill** and the Dark-rumped Swift, among many others. Also found in the forests are endangered Western Hoolock Gibbons.
- ❑ It is covered with bamboo and other grass species. The valley harbours many species of flowering plants including the endemic **Dzukou Lily- Lilium chitrangada. Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- ❑ It is home to the Angami people.

96. (c)

Explanation:

Benefits available to Non-Resident Indians:

- ❑ Non-Resident Indians receive all benefits as available to Indian citizens subject to notifications issued by the Government from time to time. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**

Benefits available to OCI Cardholders:

- ❑ Multiple entry lifelong visa for visiting India for any purpose.
- ❑ However, OCI Cardholders will require special permission to undertake research work in India for which they may apply the Indian Mission/ Post/ FRRO concerned. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- ❑ Exemption from registration with Foreigners Regional Registration Officer (FRRO) or Foreigners Registration Officer (FRO) for any length of stay in India.
- ❑ Parity with non-resident Indians (NRIs) in respect of all facilities available to them in economic, financial, and educational fields except in matters relating to the acquisition of agricultural or plantation properties.
- ❑ Registered Overseas Citizen of India Cardholders shall be treated at par with Non-Resident Indians in the matter of intercountry adoption of Indian children.
- ❑ Registered Overseas Citizen of India Cardholders shall be treated at par with resident Indian nationals in the matter of tariffs in airfares in domestic sectors in India.



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**97. (b)****Explanation:****About Li-ion Batteries:**

- A lithium-ion battery or Li-ion battery is a type of **rechargeable battery**.
- The battery consists of electrolyte, which allows for **ionic movement**, and the two electrodes are the constituent components of a lithium-ion battery cell.
- Lithium ions move from the **negative electrode** to the **positive electrode during discharge and back when charging**.

❑ Lithium-ion Battery Applications:

- Electronic gadgets, Tele-communication, Aerospace, Industrial applications.
- Lithium-ion battery technology has made it the favourite power source for electric and hybrid electric vehicles.

❑ Advantages

- **High energy density**- potential for yet higher capacities. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- **Relatively low self-discharge**- self-discharge is less than half that of nickel-based batteries.
- **Low Maintenance**- no periodic discharge is needed.
- Speciality cells can provide very high current to applications such as power tools.

❑ Disadvantages of Li-ion Batteries:

- **Long charging times. Hence, statement 3 is NOT correct.**
- Safety issues as instances of batteries catching fires have been there.
- **Expensive to manufacture. Hence, 2 is NOT correct.**
- While the Li-ion batteries are seen as sufficiently efficient for applications such as phones and laptops, in the case of EVs, these cells still lack the range that would make them a viable alternative to internal combustion engines.

for Backward Classes Act, 1993. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**

- ❑ Later, the 102nd Amendment Act of 2018 conferred a constitutional status on the Commission.
- ❑ For this purpose, the amendment inserted a new Article 338-B in the constitution.
- ❑ Hence, the Commission ceased to be a statutory body and became a constitutional body.

The functions of the Commission are the following:

- To investigate and monitor all matters relating to the constitutional and other legal safeguards for the socially and educationally backward classes and to evaluate their working.
- To inquire into specific complaints with respect to the deprivation of rights and safeguards of the socially and educationally backward classes. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- To participate and advise on the socioeconomic development of the socially and educationally backward classes and to evaluate the progress of their development under the Union or a state.
- To present to the President, annually and at such other times as it may deem fit, reports upon the working of those safeguards.
- To make recommendations as to the measures that should be taken by the Union or a state for the effective implementation of those safeguards and other measures for the protection, welfare and socio-economic development of the socially and educationally backward classes.
- To discharge such other functions in relation to the protection, welfare, development and advancement of the socially and educational.

Report of the Commission

- ❑ The Commission presents an annual report to the President.
- ❑ The President places all such reports before the Parliament, along with a memorandum explaining the action taken on the recommendations made by the Commission.

99. (d)**Explanation:**

In a bid to rectify the defects of the Regulating Act of 1773, the British Parliament passed the Amending Act of 1781, also known as the Act of Settlement. The next important act was the Pitt's India Act of 1784.

98. (c)**Explanation:****National Commission of the Backward Classes**

- ❑ The National Commission for Backward Classes (NCBC) was set up in 1993 by the National Commission



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**Features of Pitt's India Act of 1784**

- ❑ It distinguished between the commercial and political functions of the Company.
- ❑ It allowed the Court of Directors to manage the commercial affairs.
- ❑ It created a new body called the Board of Control to manage political affairs. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**
- ❑ Thus, it established a system of double government. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- ❑ It empowered the Board of Control to supervise and direct all operations of the civil and military government or revenues of the British possessions in India.

The act was significant for two reasons:

- ❑ The Company's territories in India were for the first time called the 'British possessions in India';
- ❑ The British Government was given supreme control over Company's affairs and its administration in India. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

100. (b)**Explanation:**

National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority (NPPA), was established in 1997 as an independent body of experts as per the decision taken by the Cabinet committee in

1994 while reviewing Drug Policy as regulator for pricing of drugs.

- ❑ It has been constituted as an **attached office of the Department of Pharmaceuticals (DoP), Ministry of Chemicals & Fertilizers. Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- ❑ The Authority has been entrusted with the task of:
 - Fixation/revision of prices of pharmaceutical products (bulk drugs and formulations).
 - Enforcement of provisions of the Drugs (Prices Control) Order. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
 - Monitoring of the prices of controlled and decontrolled drugs in the country.
- ❑ The NPPA currently **fixes prices of drugs placed in the National List of Essential Medicines (NLEM) under Schedule-I of the DPCO.**
- ❑ Non-scheduled drugs are allowed an increase of up to 10 per cent in prices every year, which is monitored by the NPPA.
- ❑ NPPA can also fix the price for non-scheduled drugs by invoking extraordinary powers in public interest, under the Drugs (Prices Control) Order, 2013. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**



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